CASE STUDY: ELECTORAL DATA ANALYSIS

THE METAMORPHOSIS OF POWER in Alfredo Chaves

we no longer live like our parents

A case study of six municipal elections in Alfredo Chaves, Espírito Santo (Brazil), from 2004 to 2024. After five consecutive losses in the mayoral race, the analyzed group's candidacy won in 2024 in all 42 voting precincts in the municipality, against 1 of 36 precincts in 2020.

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ELECTIONS
Municipal, 2004 to 2024

DATA
TSE and IBGE (open data)

2026

ABSTRACT

A case study of six municipal elections in Alfredo Chaves, Espírito Santo (Brazil), from 2004 to 2024. After five consecutive losses in the mayoral race, the analyzed group's candidacy won in 2024 in all 42 voting precincts in the municipality, against 1 of 36 precincts in 2020. The analysis uses open data from the Superior Electoral Court (TSE: precinct-level results, candidacies, campaign finance filings, registered polls) cross-referenced with IBGE data, in Python, SQL and R, and presents the results in interactive charts. The final section gathers scenarios for 2028, stated as assumptions rather than a forecast.

Keywords: municipal elections; Alfredo Chaves; open data; TSE; electoral data analysis; electoral scenarios.

HOW TO CITE

> Meneghel, J. V. (2026). **The metamorphosis of power in Alfredo Chaves**: We no longer live like our parents [Case study]. https://menegheljv.github.io/the-metamorphosis-of-power/en/

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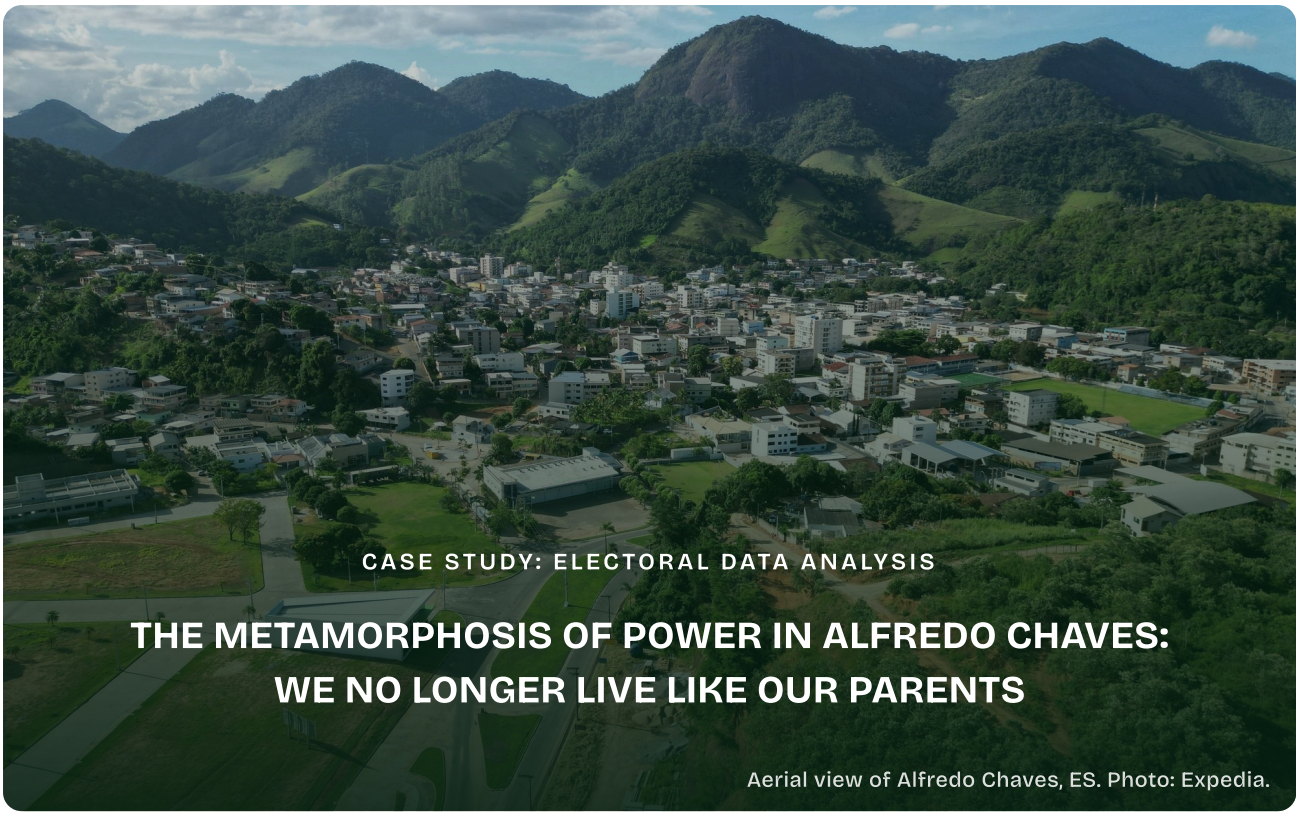
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CASE STUDY: ELECTORAL DATA ANALYSIS

THE METAMORPHOSIS OF POWER IN ALFREDO CHAVES: WE NO LONGER LIVE LIKE OUR PARENTS

Aerial view of Alfredo Chaves, ES. Photo: Expedia.

A political base that had lost five straight mayoral elections won all 42 precincts in 2024 (58.1% of valid votes) with no change in turnout: the data indicate the turnaround came from people who already voted, across the whole territory. Built only from open data, the reconstruction works as a method for any Brazilian municipality.

Author: João Victor Meneghel **Municipality:** Alfredo Chaves, ES, Brazil

Elections: Municipal, 2004 to 2024 **Source:** TSE and IBGE

1 → 42

voting precincts won by the mayoral candidacy, from 2020 to 2024 (out of 42 active precincts in 2024)

40.0% → 58.1%

valid votes (blank and null ballots excluded) for the mayoral candidate citywide, first round of each election

3/9 → 5/9

slate's seats on the City Council (from minority in 2020 to majority in 2024, same political base)

ABOUT THE TITLE

WE NO LONGER LIVE LIKE OUR PARENTS

The title is a reference to **"Como Nossos Pais"** ("Like Our Parents"), by Belchior (1976, immortalized in Elis Regina's voice), one of the most iconic songs in Brazilian popular music. It's about people who insist on living stuck in the past and fail to notice that the new always arrives, sooner or later. Here that theme takes on a literal meaning: the data in this study shows, precinct by precinct, year by year, twenty years of an old political guard that survived five straight elections before finally being replaced. A metamorphosis of power, and, within it, the real distance between my father's defeated candidacy in 2004 and my brother's win two decades later.

00.1 · TWENTY YEARS OF DATA

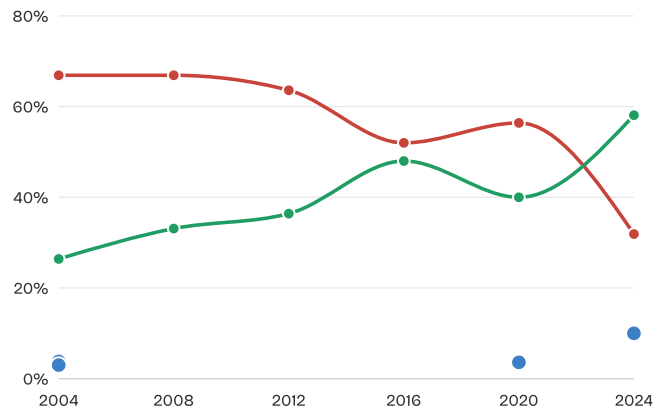
FIVE LOSSES AND THE TURNAROUND

Before the 2020→2024 turnaround documented below, this same municipality carries a longer story. From 2004 to 2020, the group behind this candidacy lost five consecutive mayoral elections in Alfredo Chaves, Brazil. In 2004 the candidate was Jorge Gabriel Meneghel, my father. The family and political lineage runs through every cycle since, up to my brother Hugo Luiz in 2024. The chart below is built from the same official TSE data by voting precinct, across all six elections, and shows the vote share closing the gap, cycle by cycle, until 2024.

FIGURE 0.1 Vote share of the group and of the main opposition candidacy, 2004–2024

FIVE LOSSES AND THE TURNAROUND

% of valid votes for every mayoral candidate, 2004–2024



Opposition · Group · Other candidates

2004
- Dr. Fernando — PSB · 66.9% · elected
- Jorge Meneghel — PT · 26.4%
- Luiz Teixeira — PV · 3.8%
- Nelsão Togneri — PFL · 3.0%

2008
- Dr. Fernando — PSB · 66.9% · elected
- Daniel Orlandi — PSDB · 33.1%

2012
- Roberto Fiorin — PSB · 63.6% · elected
- Sergio Bianchi — PSD · 36.4%

2016
- Dr. Fernando — PSB · 52.0% · elected
- Ronaldo Bianchi — PMDB · 48.0%

2020
- Dr. Fernando — PSB · 56.4% · elected
- Ronaldo Bianchi — Republicanos · 40.0%
- Armando Zanata — PDT · 3.6%

2024
- Hugo Luiz — PP · 58.1% · elected
- Rolmar Botecchia — PSB · 31.9%
- Boldrini — PL · 10.0%

In five consecutive elections the main opposition candidacy beat the group, with the gap narrowing from 66.9% to 26.4% in 2004 to 52.0% to 48.0% in 2016. In 2024 the relationship flips: the group's candidate gets 58.1% and the main opposition, 31.9%. The blue dots are the other candidates: Luiz Teixeira (PV) and Nelsão Togneri (PFL) in 2004, Armando Zanata (PDT) in 2020 and Boldrini (PL) in 2024; in 2008, 2012 and 2016 there were only two candidates. The list under the chart names everyone, and Table 0.1 has the votes.

TABLE 0.1 Every mayoral candidate, 2004–2024

WHO RAN IN EACH ELECTION

official TSE result; the dot marks the side: green = group, red = main opposition, blue = other candidates

YEAR	CANDIDATE	PARTY	VOTES	% OF VALID VOTES	RESULT
2004	Dr. Fernando	PSB	5,330	66.9%	Elected
2004	Jorge Meneghel	PT	2,107	26.4%	Not elected
2004	Luiz Teixeira	PV	299	3.8%	Not elected
2004	Nelsão Togneri	PFL	236	3.0%	Not elected
2008	Dr. Fernando	PSB	5,996	66.9%	Elected
2008	Daniel Orlandi	PSDB	2,969	33.1%	Not elected
2012	Roberto Fiorin	PSB	5,615	63.6%	Elected
2012	Sergio Bianchi	PSD	3,215	36.4%	Not elected
2016	Dr. Fernando	PSB	5,019	52.0%	Elected
2016	Ronaldo Bianchi	PMDB	4,641	48.0%	Not elected
2020	Dr. Fernando	PSB	5,196	56.4%	Elected
2020	Ronaldo Bianchi	Republicanos	3,681	40.0%	Not elected
2020	Armando Zanata	PDT	336	3.6%	Not elected
2024	Hugo Luiz	PP	5,779	58.1%	Elected
2024	Rolmar Botecchia	PSB	3,177	31.9%	Not elected
2024	Boldrini	PL	999	10.0%	Not elected

Percentages are of valid votes (blank and null votes excluded). Four candidates ran for mayor in 2004; two in 2008, 2012 and 2016; three in 2020 and 2024.

Full disclosure. Jorge Gabriel Meneghel, the 2004 candidate, is my father. Hugo Luiz, who won in 2024, is my brother, and I directed his campaign that year. The project grew out of that work; the data pipeline came after, to understand what actually moved the result.

01 · CONTEXT

ONE ELECTION, SAME POLITICAL BASE

I worked as campaign director in the 2024 municipal election in Alfredo Chaves, Brazil, for the majoritarian mayoral candidacy of Hugo Luiz Picoli Meneghel. I wasn't involved in running the 2020 campaign: I use that year's public data only as a comparison point, to measure the distance between the two elections. That year the slate lost the mayoral race, winning just 1 of the 36 voting precincts that existed at the time; Hugo Luiz had already been elected to the City Council in that same election, but as part of a bloc holding only 3 of 9 seats, a clear minority. In 2024, also coordinating the campaigns of the coalition's other

council candidates, the same political base won **all 42 voting precincts in the municipality**: Hugo Luiz became the youngest mayor in the history of Espírito Santo state, and the slate's bloc grew from 3 to **5 of the 9 seats** on the Council, from minority to majority.

This document reconstructs that turnaround entirely from **open, official TSE data**, without relying on memory, internal campaign spreadsheets, or any non-public record. It's an exercise in technical analysis over a real electoral dataset.

02 · DATA SOURCE

TSE'S OPEN ELECTORAL DATA REPOSITORY

Every number in this study comes from extracts of the TSE Open Data Portal (Brazil's Superior Electoral Court), filtered to the municipality of Alfredo Chaves, Espírito Santo (TSE code 56057), electoral zone 012, for the six municipal elections from 2004 to 2024. Table 3.1 (section 03) shows what exists for each year:

- `votacao_secao_YEAR_ES.csv`: votes by voting precinct, 2004 to 2024 (from 1,229 rows in 2004 to 2,089 in 2024, after the municipal filter)
- `votacao_candidato_munzona_YEAR_ES.csv`: consolidated result per candidate, 2004 to 2024 (45 to 73 records per election, adding mayoral, vice-mayoral and council candidates)
- `votacao_partido_munzona_2020/2024_ES.csv`: party-line vote totals, 2020 and 2024 only (9 and 11 records)
- `detalhe_votacao_munzona_YEAR_ES.csv`: turnout, abstention, blank/null votes, 2004 to 2024
- `prestacao_de_contas_eleitorais_candidatos_YEAR.csv` (revenue and paid expenses, 2004 to 2024): extracted via *HTTP range requests* from a ~1.3 GB national file, without downloading the whole thing
- `bem_candidato_YEAR_ES.csv`: assets declared by candidates, 2008 to 2024
- `perfil_eleitor_secao_YEAR_ES.csv`: electorate profile by precinct (gender, age bracket, education), 2008 to 2024
- `consulta_cand_YEAR_ES.csv`: candidacy registry, 2004 to 2024 (gender, date of birth, education and occupation; race/color is only recorded from 2016)

> **Transparency note.** The continuity between the two majoritarian candidacies (2020 to 2024) is reconstructed from verifiable coincidences in the official data: the same local party base (Republicanos/PTB), and the fact that the 2024 winner, Hugo Luiz Picoli Meneghel, appears in the 2020 data as a city council candidate elected on the coalition that lost the mayoral race that year. No number was estimated, projected, or invented: where a figure wasn't publicly available, it was left out rather than approximated. The only exception is section 11, whose 2028 scenarios are stated assumptions, calculated in R.

Additional sources

Several sections of this study cross-reference or cite sources outside the TSE repository, always identified where they appear:

- **IBGE, SIDRA**: table 6579 (estimated resident population, section 06) and tables 9514 and 9605 of the 2022 Demographic Census (sex and race/color, section 06).
- **IBGE, Territorial Meshes**: the municipality's official boundary, used in the polling-location map (section 09).
- **Alfredo Chaves city hall**: the official list of districts and localities, used to assign each voting precinct to a district (section 04).
- **TSE, pesqele-divulgação**: the election-poll registration system (Law 9,504/97, Article 33), consulted for the 9 polls from 2024 (section 08).
- **Alfredo Chaves City Council, SPL**: the legislative record consulted for Commendation Motion No. 003/2024 (section 06).
- **The candidacy's official Instagram** (@hugoluiz11_): the 2024 post history, the only source in this study that isn't public, auditable data (section 07, with caveats detailed there).
- **IPESES**: a post-election opinion poll from March 2026, cited as additional context, outside the TSE's electoral scope (section 08).

03 · METHODOLOGY

DATA-PROCESSING PIPELINE

The raw extracts go through five steps before any comparative analysis: a standard ingestion, cleaning, and load pipeline, implemented in Python (pandas), with the analytical layer in SQL (SQLite). A SQLite database gathers all six elections (votes by precinct, candidates, turnout and districts) and five SQL queries reproduce the study's central results; a script checks each result against the pandas pipeline. The financing, assets, profile and

IBGE analyses read the filtered CSVs directly in pandas, with the same cleaning rules. The interactive charts illustrating the study are written in TypeScript (React and Recharts) and styled with CSS.

01

Ingestion

Read the official CSVs (`;`-separated, UTF-8), raw typing as text

02

Cleaning

Type conversion (zone, precinct, votes), name/office normalization, drop administrative columns

03

Normalization

Standardize keys (precinct, zone, year) to allow joins across elections

04

Load

Write all six elections to SQLite: 5 tables (`votos_secao`, `candidatos`, `detalhe_votacao`, `local_secao`, `grupo_eleicao`) and 2 views

05

SQL analysis

Five queries (CTEs, window functions, joins), automatically checked against pandas

TABLE 3.1 Data available for each election

WHAT EXISTS FOR EACH ELECTION

coverage of the TSE datasets used in this study

YEAR	VOTING PRECINCTS	CANDIDATES		REVENUE AND EXPENSES	DECLARED ASSETS	ELECTORATE PROFILE	PARTY-LINE VOTES	CANDIDATE PROFILE
		MAYORAL	COUNCIL					
2004	33	4	40	Yes	No	No	No	Yes
2008	34	2	41	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
2012	34	2	64	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
2016	36	2	61	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
2020	36	3	69	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
2024	42	3	70	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Comparisons across all six elections (results, turnout, financing, districts) rely on the complete columns. The council slate by district and party-line votes exist only for 2020 and 2024; assets and the electorate profile start in 2008; the candidate profile (age, education, occupation) exists for all six elections. Where a dataset

does not cover a year, the study does not estimate: it leaves it out. The candidate columns count registered mayoral and council candidacies separately; vice-mayoral candidates are left out.

Cleaning and normalization (pandas)

FIGURE 1 clean_secao(): pipeline excerpt

```
-- precincts won by the group, by year (sql/02_secoes_vencidas.sql, 2004 to 2024)
SELECT ano, COUNT(*) AS secoes,
       SUM(CASE WHEN votos_grupo > 0 AND votos_grupo = max_secao THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS
secoes_vencidas
FROM v_prefeito_secao   -- valid votes: excludes blank (95) and null (96) ballots
GROUP BY ano
-- result: 2020 = 1 of 36 precincts; 2024 = 42 of 42
```

Comparative analysis (SQL)

FIGURE 2 winner by precinct, by year

```
-- winner of each precinct, by year (highest nominal vote count for Mayor)
SELECT NR_SECAO, NM_VOTAVEL, SUM(QT_VOTOS) AS votes
FROM secao_2024
WHERE DS_CARGO = 'Prefeito' AND NR_VOTAVEL > 0
GROUP BY NR_SECAO, NM_VOTAVEL
-- (identical for secao_2020; winner = MAX(votes) per NR_SECAO)
```

Joining `2020` ⋈⋈ `2024` by precinct number allows comparison of only the **36 precincts present in both elections** (6 new precincts were created by 2024, reflecting electorate growth, and enter the analysis only as a 2024 result).

04 · KEY FINDINGS

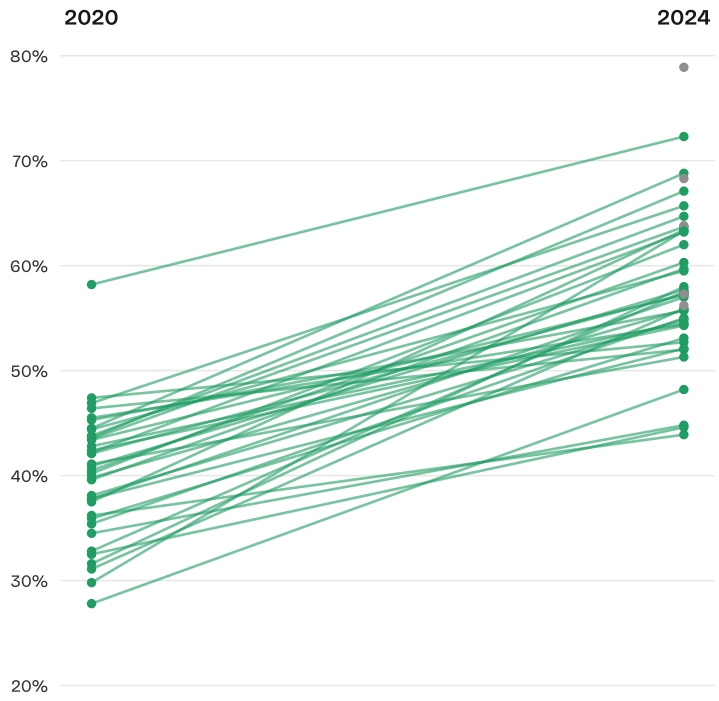
FROM A BROAD DEFEAT TO A WIN IN EVERY PRECINCT

In 2020, this political base's majoritarian candidacy won **just 1 of 36 comparable precincts** (precinct 9), taking 40.0% of the valid vote citywide (3,681 votes), against 56.4% for the winning candidate. In 2024, the same base, now under the coalition **"Renovação e Juventude"** ("Renewal and Youth"; Republicanos / PP / MDB / PSDB-Cidadania federation), won **all 42 precincts** in the municipality, with 58.1% of the valid vote (5,779 votes).

FIGURE 3 % of votes by precinct, 2020 vs. 2024

THE TURNAROUND, PRECINCT BY PRECINCT

% of votes for the group's candidate in each precinct, 2020 → 2024



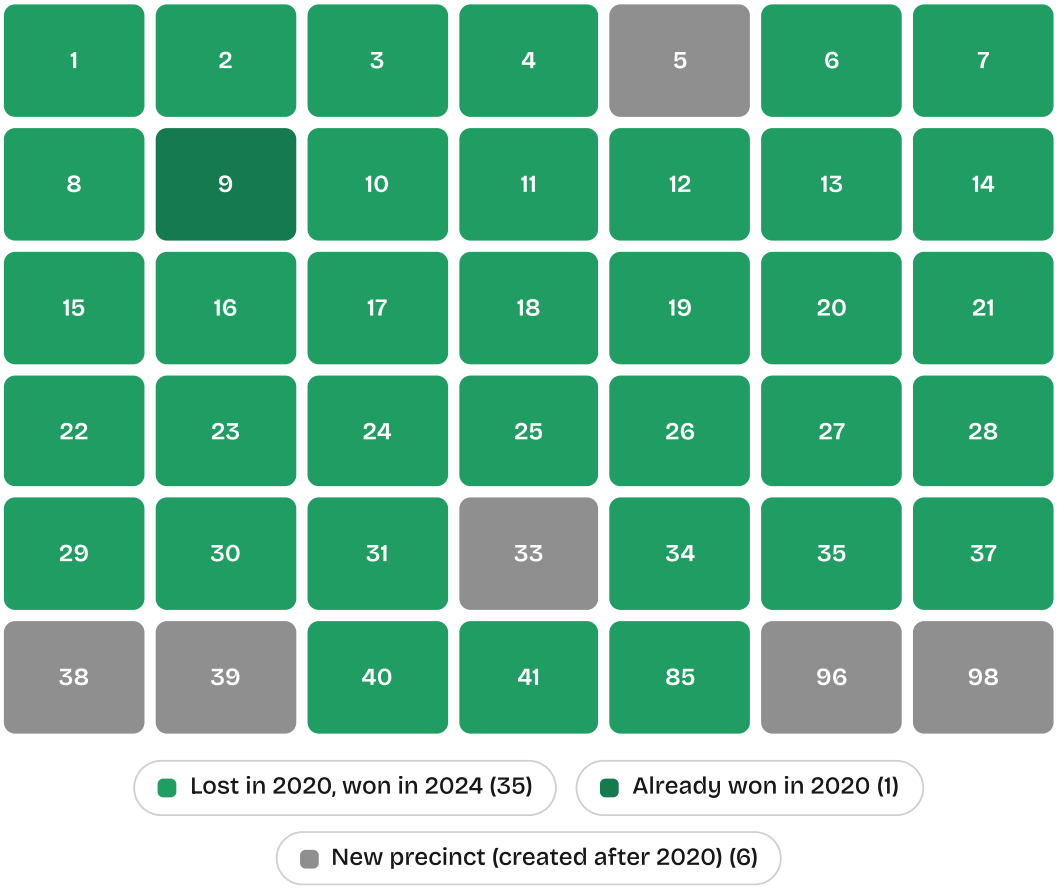
Each line is one voting precinct. In **2020** nearly all sit below 50% (a loss); by **2024** most cross the absolute-majority line. Precincts with no 2020 data didn't exist yet in that election.

Of the 36 comparable precincts, **31 moved from a minority (<50%) to an absolute majority (≥50%)** of the valid vote between the two elections, a swing averaging 17.9 percentage points in those precincts.

FIGURE 4 All 42 precincts of Alfredo Chaves in 2024

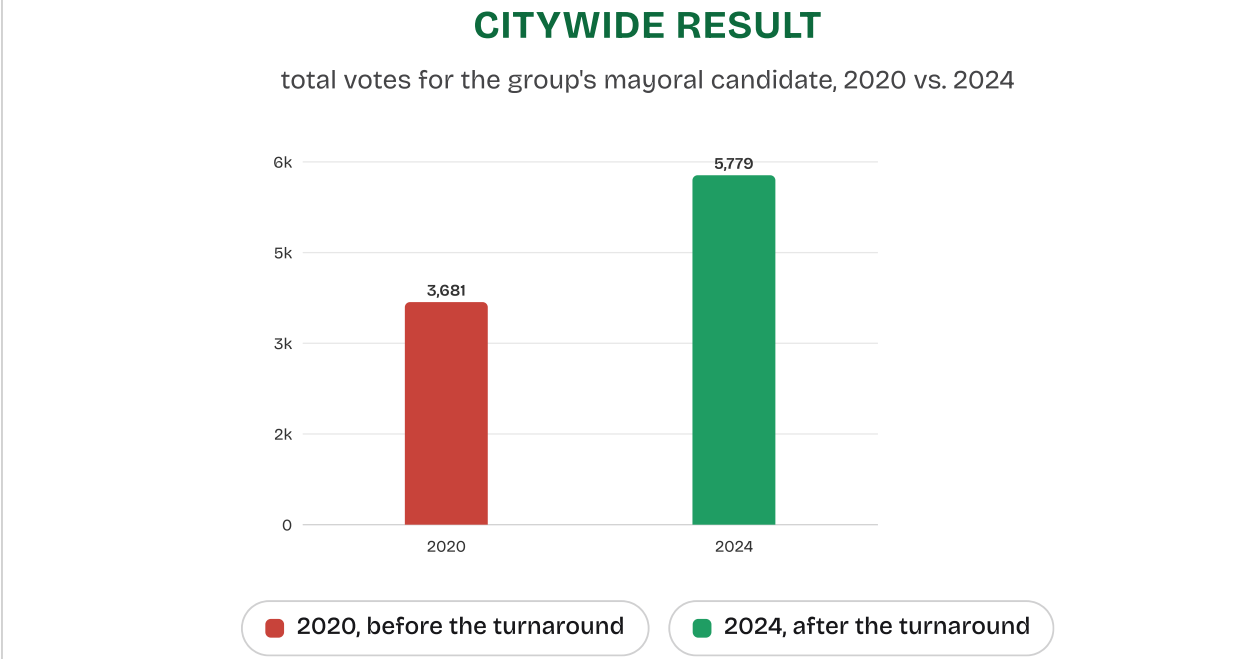
ALL 42 VOTING PRECINCTS IN 2024

Tap or hover to see the polling place of each precinct



In 2024, the candidacy won literally every precinct in the municipality, including the 6 new ones created since 2020.

FIGURE 5 Citywide aggregate result



A different party every election

The `consulta_cand` data shows the group's candidate never ran under the same party twice in twenty years: PT in 2004, PSDB in 2008, PSD in 2012, PMDB in 2016, Republicanos in 2020, PP in 2024. The ideological spectrum shifted too, from a left-wing party in 2004 to center and right-wing parties from 2012 on, tracking the national realignment of Brazilian politics over the period. It doesn't look like an isolated local strategy choice.

Coalition size, though, **doesn't explain the win on its own**: in 2016, the candidate ran with the largest coalition of the whole series (9 parties) and still lost, with 48.0% of the vote. In 2020, with the smallest coalition (3 parties), he also lost. The 2024 coalition (5 parties: Republicanos, PP, MDB and the PSDB-Cidadania federation) is mid-sized within the series, neither the largest nor the smallest.

On the opposing side, the pattern is the reverse. In the five elections this group lost, between 2004 and 2020, the winner was always **PSB**: Dr. Fernando took 2004, 2008, 2016 and 2020, and Roberto Fiorin, also PSB, took 2012, four terms and two different names under the same party label, twenty years straight. That streak only breaks in 2024, when Rolmar Botecchia tries to keep PSB in power and loses to Hugo Luiz's PP. In other words, while the losing side changed parties every election, the winning side had a stable label for two decades. It was precisely that stability that broke in 2024, along with the result.

The stability of the PSB label hid a set of parties that changed in 2024. The PP, the PSDB and Cidadania were part of the PSB coalition in 2020 and, in 2024, moved to the group's coalition, together with Republicanos and MDB. Of the five parties in the winning coalition, three (60%) came from the coalition that had just governed. Political alignment, therefore, cannot be followed by the candidate's party label alone: the turnaround was also a migration of allies.

TABLE 5.1 Party, spectrum and coalition of the group and of the winner, 2004–2024

PARTY, SPECTRUM AND COALITION AT EACH ELECTION

the group's candidate and the winner of each race, election by election

Group's candidate

YEAR	GROUP'S PARTY	SPECTRUM	PARTIES	COALITION
2004	PT	Left	5	PPS / PT / PSDB / PTN / PT do B
2008	PSDB	Center-right	5	PTB / PSDB / PMDB / PT do B / PPS
2012	PSD	Center-right	6	PT / PTB / PMDB / PPS / DEM / PSD
2016	PMDB	Center	9	PMDB / PPS / PSD / PTB / PT / PDT / PATRIOTA / REDE / DEM
2020	Republicanos	Right	3	PTB / REPUBLICANOS / PATRIOTA
2024	PP	Right	5	REPUBLICANOS / PP / MDB / PSDB-Cidadania federation

Winning candidate

YEAR	WINNER	PARTY	SPECTRUM	PARTIES	COALITION
2004	Dr. Fernando	PSB	Center-left	5	PSB / PP / PTB / PL / PMN
2008	Dr. Fernando	PSB	Center-left	7	PR / PP / PRTB / PV / PRB / PHS / PSB
2012	Roberto Fiorin	PSB	Center-left	6	PRB / PP / PDT / PR / PSB / PSDB
2016	Dr. Fernando	PSB	Center-left	9	PSB / PROS / PMN / PSDB / PP / PSC / PR / PTN / PV
2020	Dr. Fernando	PSB	Center-left	7	PP / PSL / PODE / CIDADANIA / DEM / PSB / PSDB
2024	Hugo Luiz (group)	PP	Right	5	REPUBLICANOS / PP / MDB / PSDB-Cidadania federation

Source: `consulta_cand`, field `DS_COMPOSICAO_COLIGACAO`, TSE, per year. Spectrum classified by the candidacy's party of registration (lead party), not the whole coalition. The green row is the only win in the series; the other

five are losses (each coalition's size is discussed in the text above).

Source: `consulta_cand`, fields `SG_PARTIDO`, `DS_COMPOSICAO_COLIGACAO` and `DS_SIT_TOT_TURNO`, TSE, per year. Spectrum classified by the winner's party of registration, not the whole coalition.

Where the group was strong, where it was weak

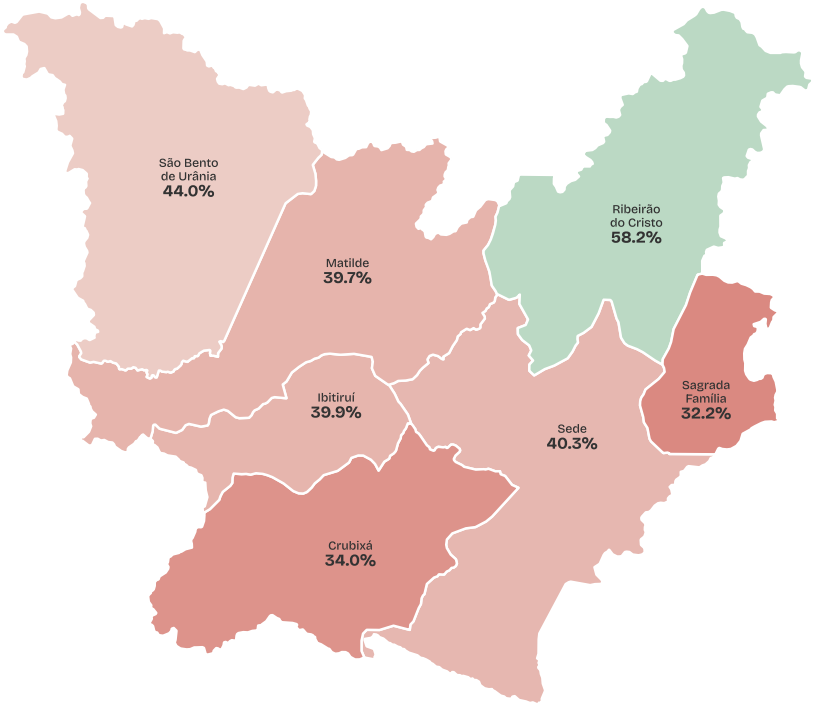
Alfredo Chaves has 7 official districts: the seat and six rural districts (Crubixá, Ibitiruí, Matilde, Ribeirão do Cristo, Sagrada Família and São Bento de Urânia). We cross-referenced each precinct's polling location, and through it its district, with the group's candidate's vote share in each of the six elections, to see whether the turnaround was even across the territory or concentrated in one corner of the municipality.

FIGURE 6 Group's mayoral candidate share, by district, 2004–2024

WHERE THE GROUP WAS STRONG

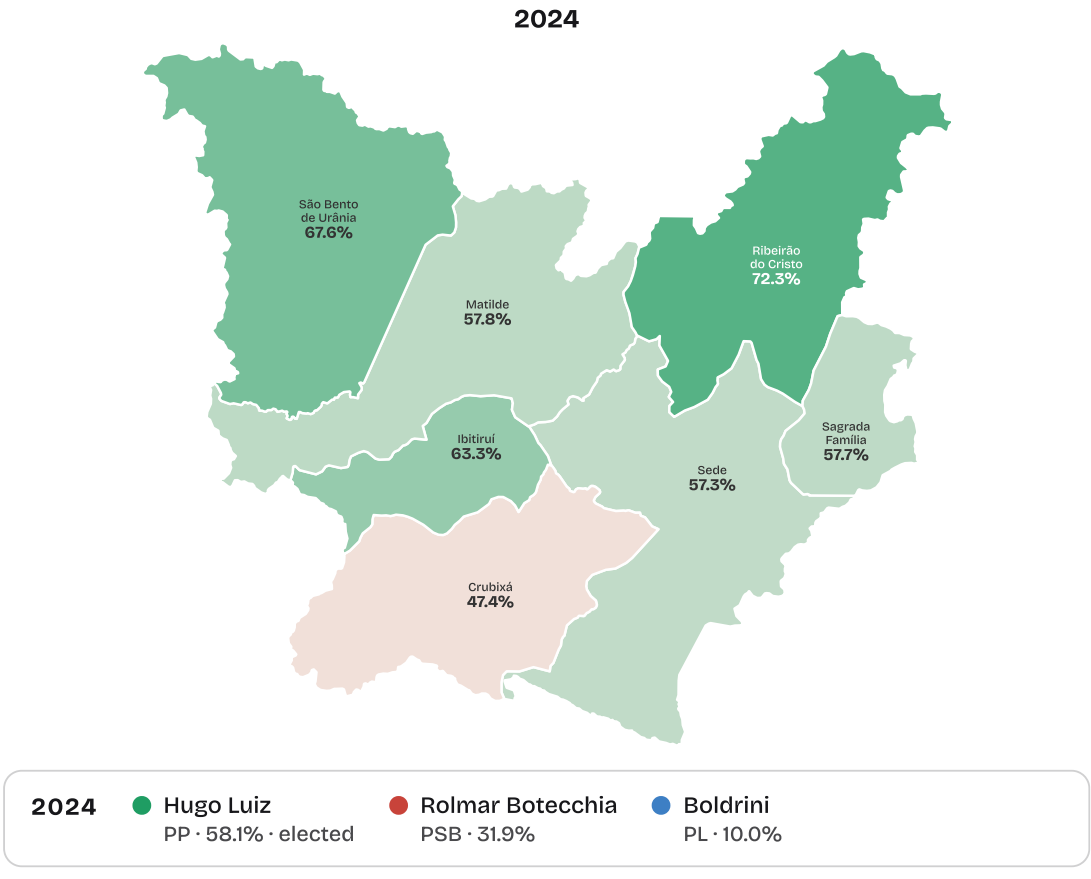
% for the group's mayoral candidate, by district:
choose the election (the list shows every candidate)

2020



2020

- Dr. Fernando — PSB · 56.4% · elected
- Ronaldo Bianchi — Republicanos · 40.0%
- Armando Zanata — PDT · 3.6%



All elections, by district

District	2004	2008	2012	2016	2020	2024
Sede	29.8%	33.9%	42.1%	49.9%	40.3%	57.3%
Crubixá	24.2%	33.1%	28.1%	41.5%	34.0%	47.4%
Ibitiruí	23.7%	30.6%	33.5%	50.3%	39.9%	63.3%
Matilde	19.2%	38.0%	27.5%	50.5%	39.7%	57.8%
Ribeirão do Cristo	8.8%	38.2%	9.4%	35.9%	58.2%	72.3%
Sagrada Família	18.7%	24.7%	30.3%	39.1%	32.2%	57.7%
São Bento de Urânia	19.2%	29.0%	12.6%	45.6%	44.0%	67.6%

Ribeirão do Cristo was by far the district most resistant to the group in 2004 and 2012 (8.8% and 9.4%, the worst numbers in the whole study), and became the most favorable in 2020 and 2024 (58.2% and 72.3%). By

2024, all seven districts are above 47%: the turnaround didn't come from one stronghold, it came from the entire territory.

Source: `votacao_secao`, TSE, all six elections. Each precinct's district determined by its 2024 polling location, cross-referenced with the official locality list from the Alfredo Chaves city hall. Precinct numbers are stable over time in this municipality (only new precincts are added, none are renumbered), so each precinct's 2024 location applies to every year it existed. Percentages weighted by each precinct's total valid votes. District boundaries: IBGE, 2022 Census district mesh. The division into seven districts (Alfredo Chaves, shown here as "Sede", the district seat; Crubixá, Ibitiruí, Matilde, Ribeirão do Cristo, Sagrada Família and Urânia, listed as São Bento de Urânia by the city hall) appears in the Municipal Basic Sanitation Plan, item 5.1 (Municipal Law No. 633/2017, repealed by Law No. 668/2019), based on IBGE.

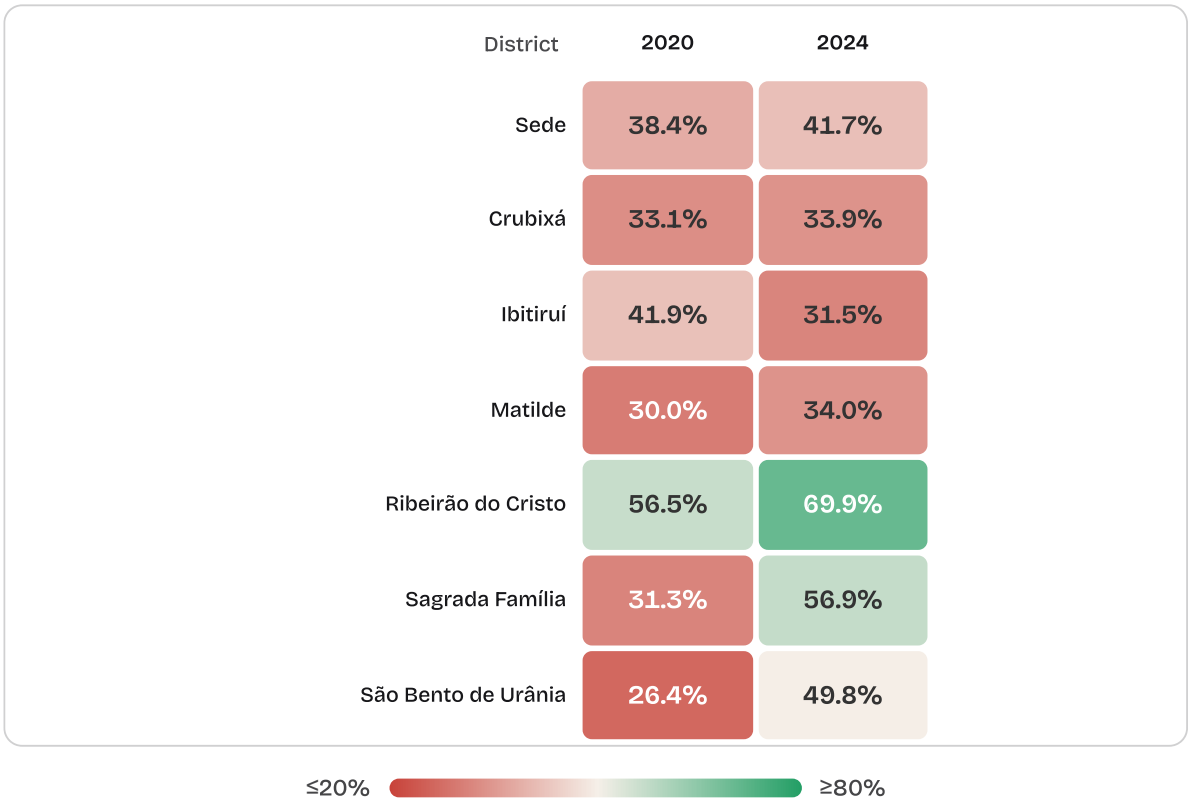
What about the council race?

The same precinct→district mapping, now for the group's **full council slate** (every candidate in the coalition, elected or not — 35 names in 2020, 30 in 2024, identified by registered party), as a % of valid council votes in each district. Only possible for 2020 and 2024: the only two elections where the family's candidacy also ran a council slate.

FIGURE 6.1 % of council votes for the group's slate, by district, 2020 and 2024

WHERE THE COUNCIL SLATE WAS STRONG

% of council votes for the group's slate, by district, 2020 and 2024



Ribeirão do Cristo, the district that swung hardest to the group in the mayoral race (Figure 6), is also the one that gives the group's council slate the most support in both years — 56.5% in 2020, 69.9% in 2024. The 2024 turnaround wasn't concentrated at the top of the slate: Sagrada Família and São Bento de Urânia nearly double their share (31.3%→56.9% and 26.4%→49.8%), tracking the same territorial movement seen in the mayoral race.

Source: `votacao_secao` and `consulta_cand` (fields `SG_PARTIDO`, `SQ_CANDIDATO`), TSE, council race, 2020 and 2024. Same precinct→district mapping as Figure 6. The group's slate is defined by each year's mayoral coalition parties (Republicanos/PTB/Patriota in 2020; Republicanos/PP/PSDB in 2024), matched by `SQ_CANDIDATO` — not by name, which varies between the candidate and precinct extracts.

In absolute numbers

The percentages in Figures 6 and 6.1 hide the size of each district. The charts below show the **total mayoral votes** in each election from 2004 to 2024, with a line for the group's candidate, another for the main opposition and dots for the other candidates; the list above the charts names everyone. Each district has its own scale: Sede holds about two thirds of valid votes, and the other six districts are too small to share the same axis.

FIGURE 6.2 Total mayoral votes by district, 2004–2024

VOTES BY DISTRICT, ELECTION BY ELECTION

total votes for each mayoral candidate, 2004–2024 (each district has its own scale; the list above names every candidate)

2004
- Dr. Fernando — PSB · 66.9% · elected
- Jorge Meneghel — PT · 26.4%
- Luiz Teixeira — PV · 3.8%
- Nelsão Togneri — PFL · 3.0%

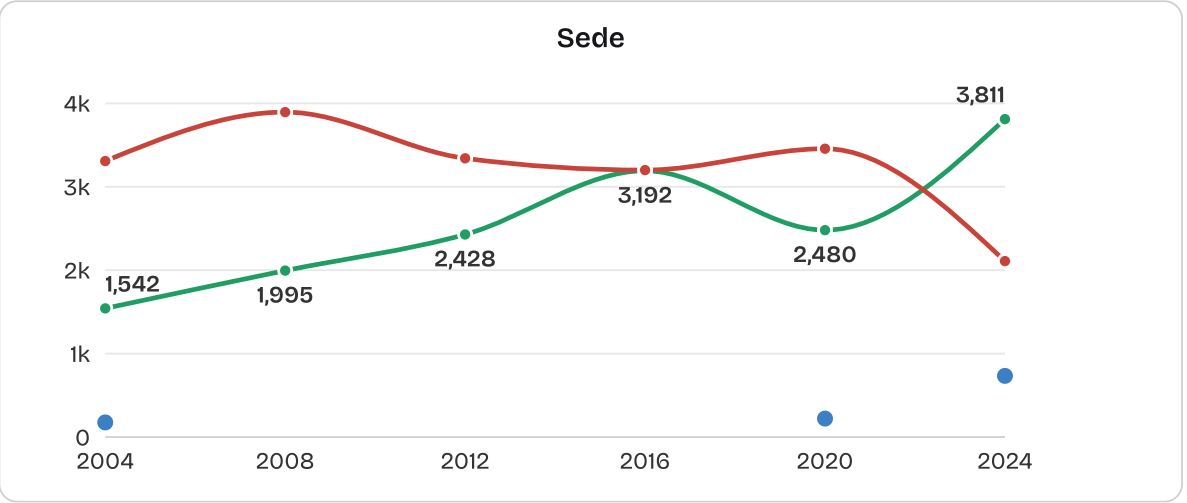
2008
- Dr. Fernando — PSB · 66.9% · elected
- Daniel Orlandi — PSDB · 33.1%

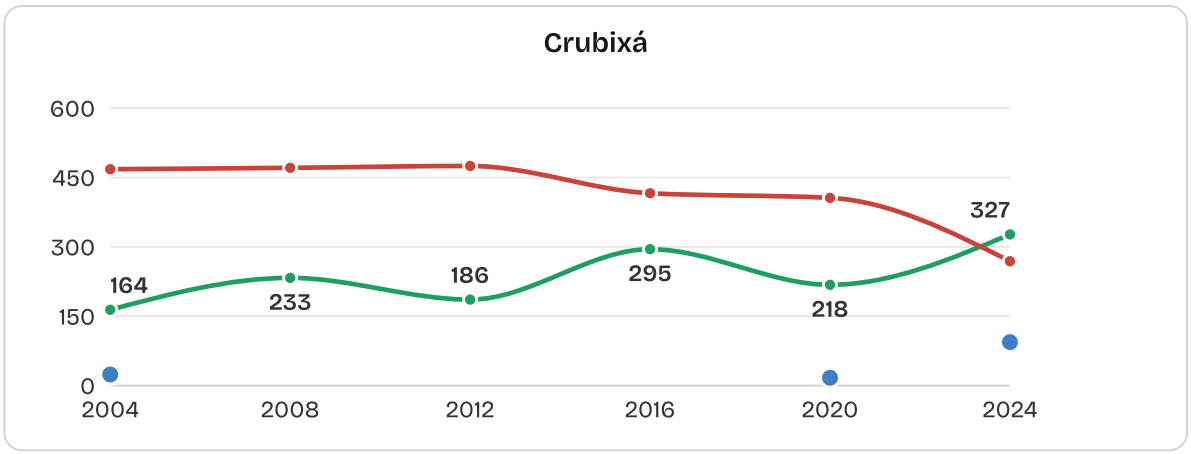
2012
- Roberto Fiorin — PSB · 63.6% · elected
- Sergio Bianchi — PSD · 36.4%

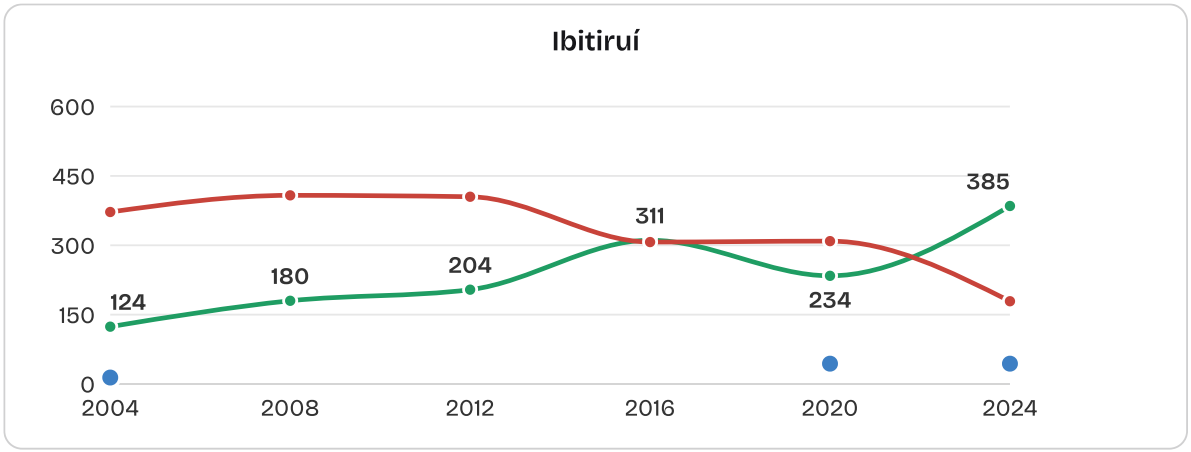
2016
- Dr. Fernando — PSB · 52.0% · elected
- Ronaldo Bianchi — PMDB · 48.0%

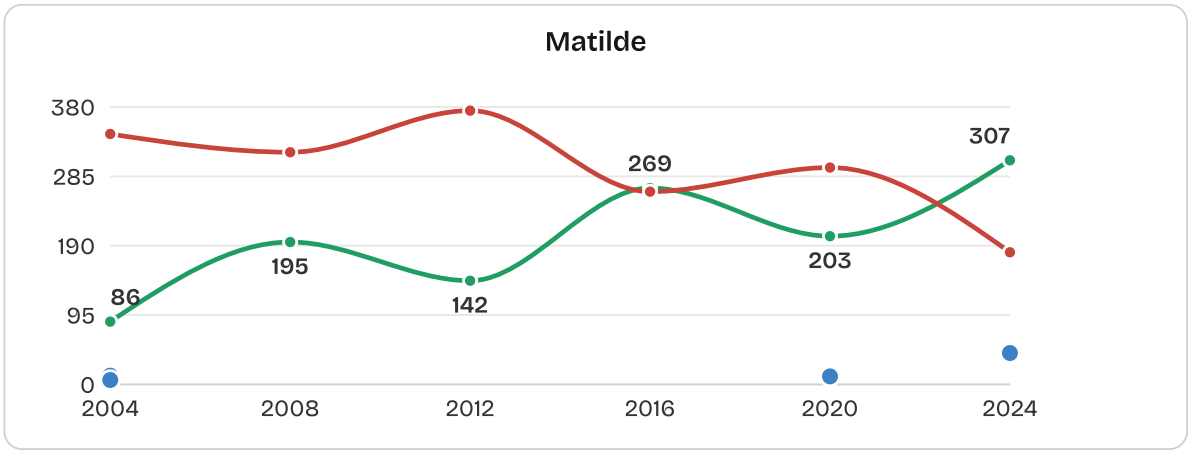
2020
- Dr. Fernando — PSB · 56.4% · elected
- Ronaldo Bianchi — Republicanos · 40.0%
- Armando Zanata — PDT · 3.6%

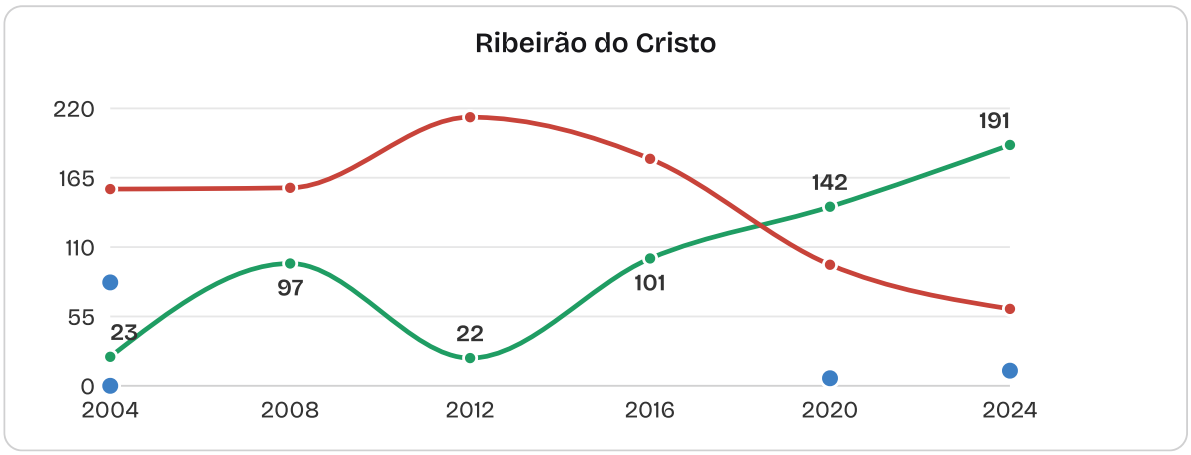
2024
- Hugo Luiz — PP · 58.1% · elected
- Rolmar Botecchia — PSB · 31.9%
- Boldrini — PL · 10.0%

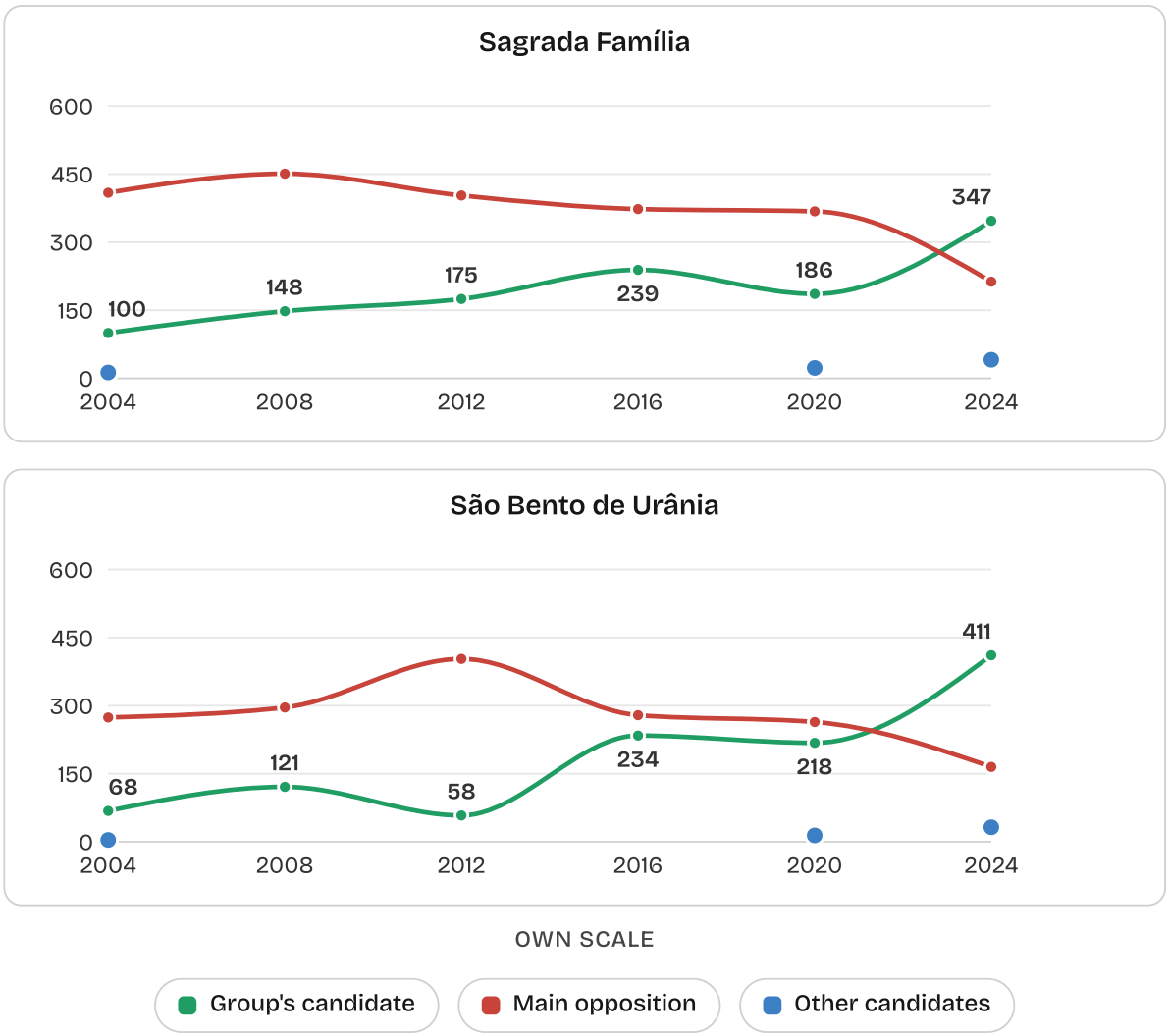



Crubixá
600
450
300
150
0
164
233
186
295
218
327
2004
2008
2012
2016
2020
2024


Ibitiruí
600
450
300
150
0
124
180
204
311
234
385
2004
2008
2012
2016
2020
2024


Matilde
380
285
190
95
0
86
195
142
269
203
307
2004
2008
2012
2016
2020
2024


Ribeirão do Cristo
220
165
110
55
0
23
97
22
101
142
191
2004
2008
2012
2016
2020
2024



Sede holds most of the votes in every election: 3,811 of the group candidate's 5,779 votes in 2024 (65.9%). Across the other six districts combined, the group goes from 1,201 votes in 2020 to 1,968 in 2024 (+64%), and in all seven districts 2024 is the election with the group's highest vote count in the whole series. Hovering over a point shows each candidate's votes in the district.

Source: votacao_secao, TSE, Mayor race, 2004 to 2024, blank and null votes excluded. Same precinct→district mapping as Figure 6.

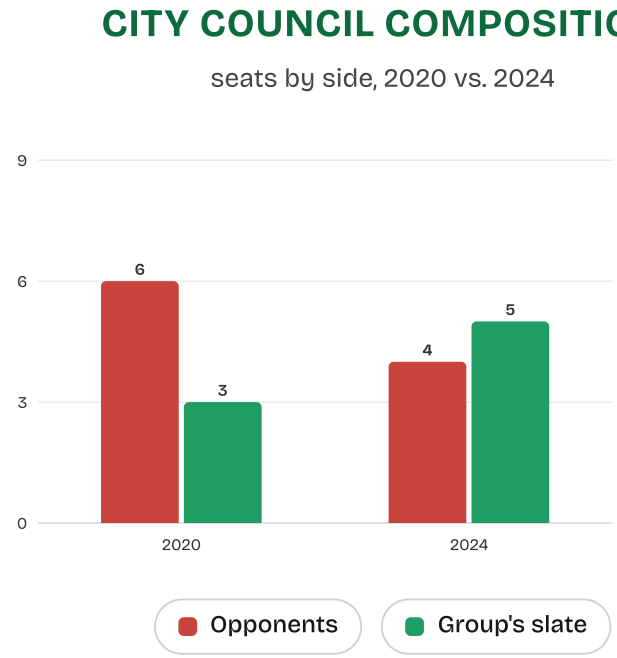
05 · LEGISLATIVE PERFORMANCE

THE POLITICAL FLIP IN THE CITY COUNCIL

Alfredo Chaves' City Council has **9 seats**. In 2020, Hugo Luiz Picoli Meneghel's political base, then a council candidate for PTB on the majoritarian coalition "Mudança com Transparência" (PTB / Republicanos / Patriota), elected only 3 council members against 6 from opposing

parties (the coalition that won the mayoral race: PP / PSB / PSDB, among others): a clear minority. In 2024, with campaign coordination extended to every council candidate on the "Renovação e Juventude" coalition (Republicanos / PP / PSDB), the slate's bloc grew to **5 of 9 seats**, a simple majority, if a tight one.

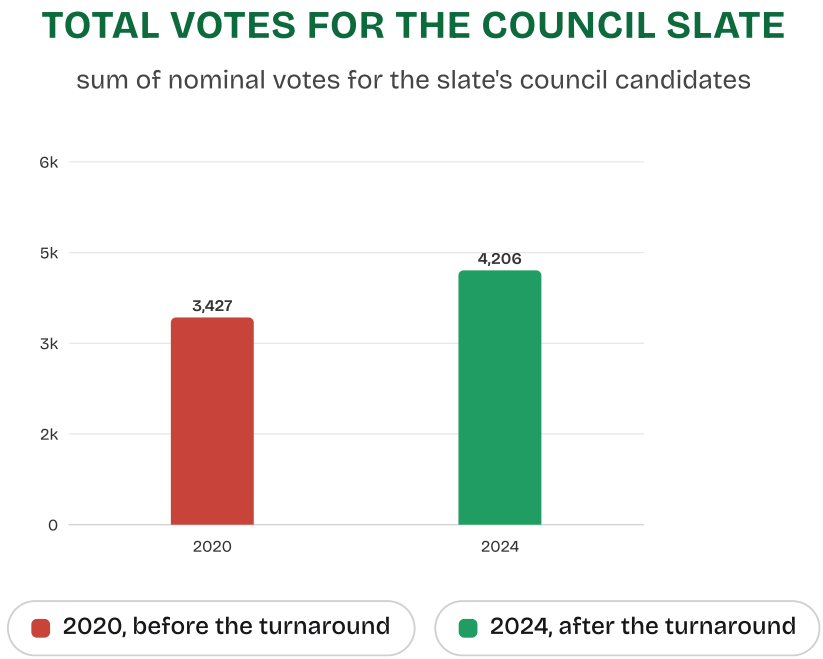
FIGURE 7 Council composition, 2020 vs. 2024



3 → 5 seats: the same political group that was an isolated minority in 2020 came to control a simple majority of the Council in 2024.

Adding up the nominal vote for *every* council candidate on the slate (elected and not), the growth shows up in the vote count too, not just the seats:

FIGURE 8 Total votes for the slate's council candidates

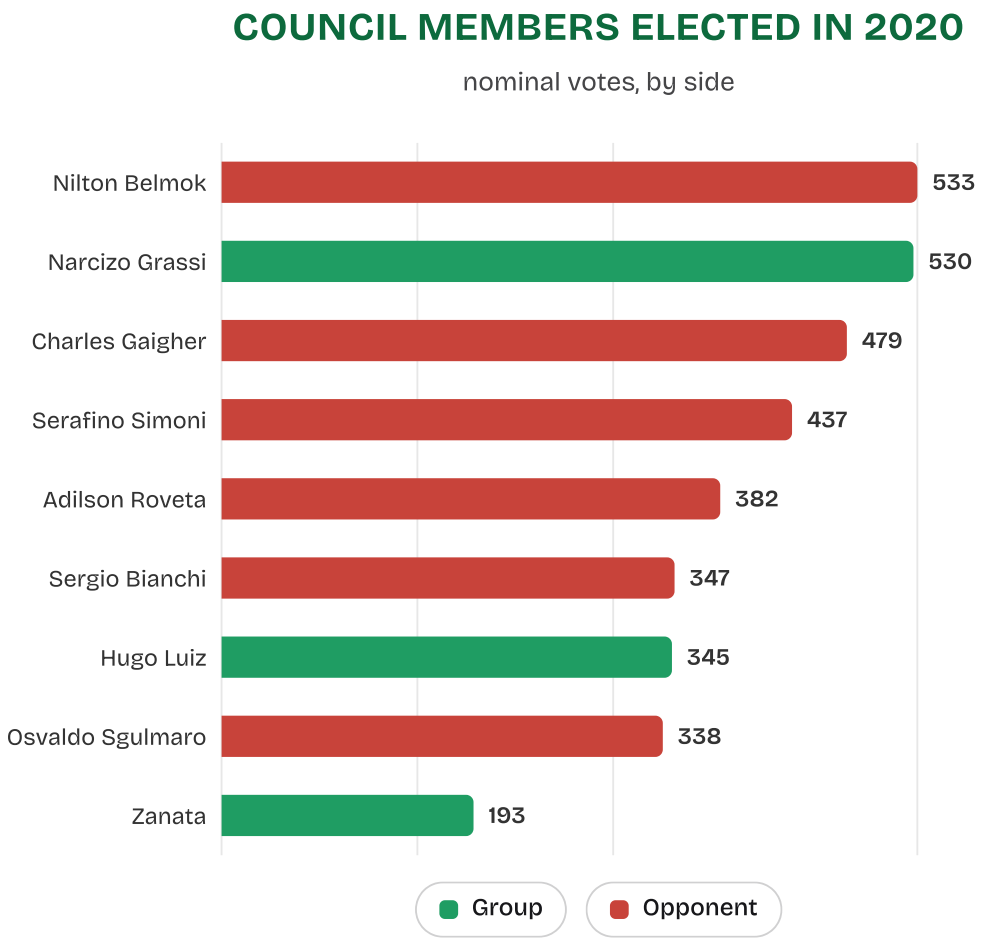


+779 votes (+22.7%) in the combined total for the slate's council candidates, from one election to the next.

Who ran each election

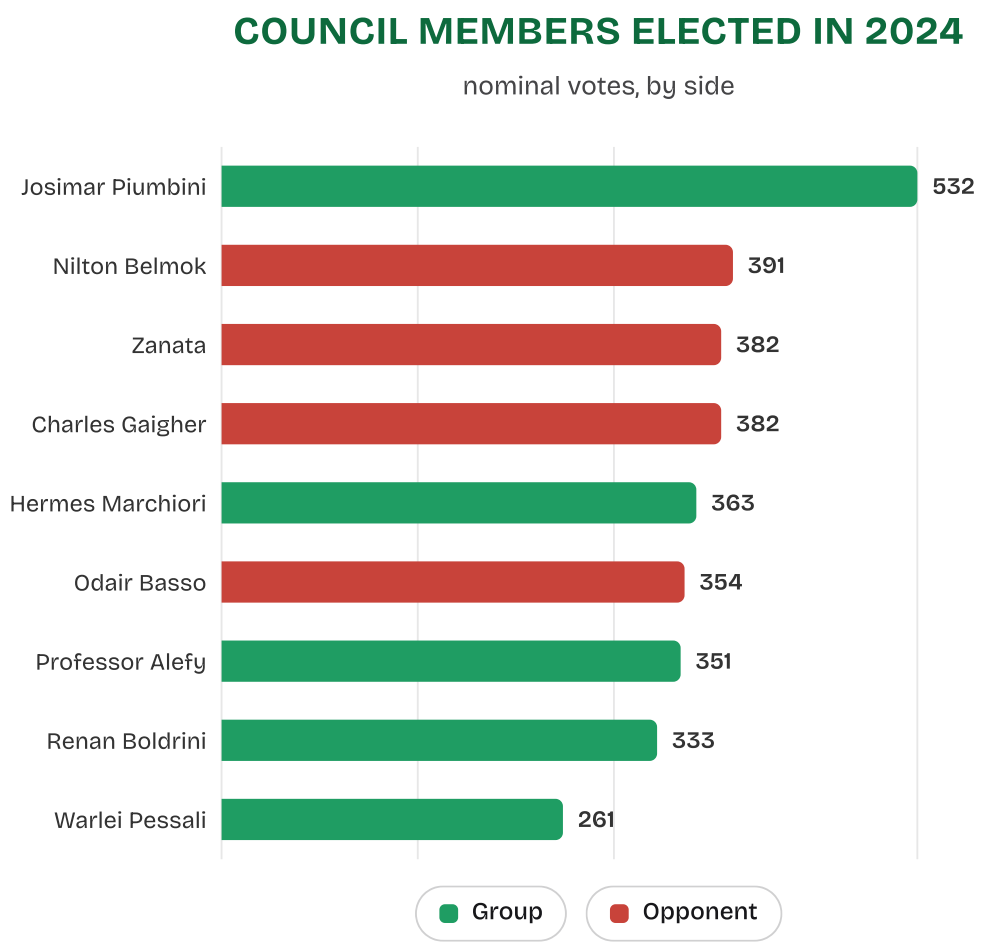
In the two charts below, green marks council members elected on Hugo Luiz's slate (the same political base in both elections); red marks those elected on opposing parties.

FIGURE 9 Council members elected in 2020



Hugo Luiz (PTB) is elected to the Council with 345 votes, but his base is left isolated in the minority (3 of 9 seats).

FIGURE 10 Council members elected in 2024



Josimar Piumbini, Hermes Marchiori, Professor Alefy, Renan Boldrini and Warlei Pessali: the 5 names on the slate that back the Hugo Luiz administration in the Council.

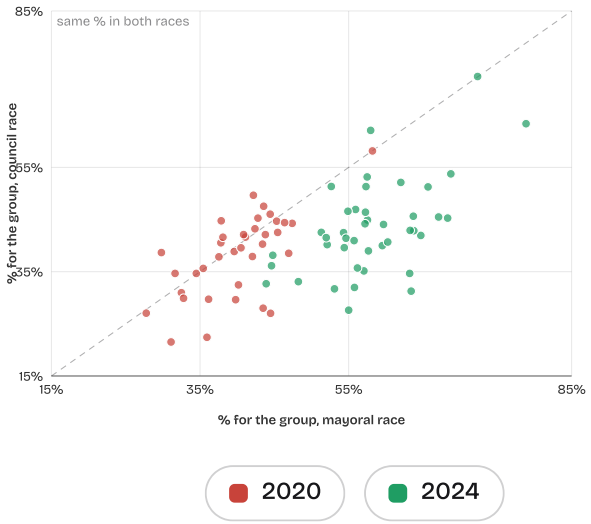
The mayoral vote pulled the council vote, but not equally in both elections

Mayor and council are separate votes on the same ballot: a voter can pick the group's candidate for mayor and an opponent for council, or the other way around. We cross-referenced, precinct by precinct, the share of valid votes for the group's mayoral candidate with the combined share of valid votes for the group's council candidates, in 2020 and in 2024.

FIGURE 11 Correlation between the mayoral and council vote, by precinct

MAYOR × COUNCIL, PRECINCT BY PRECINCT

% for the group in the mayoral race (x) and the council race (y), per precinct



The correlation was stronger in 2020 (r = 0.66) than in 2024 (r = 0.57): voters who backed Ronaldo Bianchi for mayor tended to also back the group's council candidates a bit more consistently than voters who backed Hugo Luiz. It isn't a huge gap, but it suggests the 2024 mayoral vote leaned somewhat more on Hugo's own name than on the slate as a bloc.

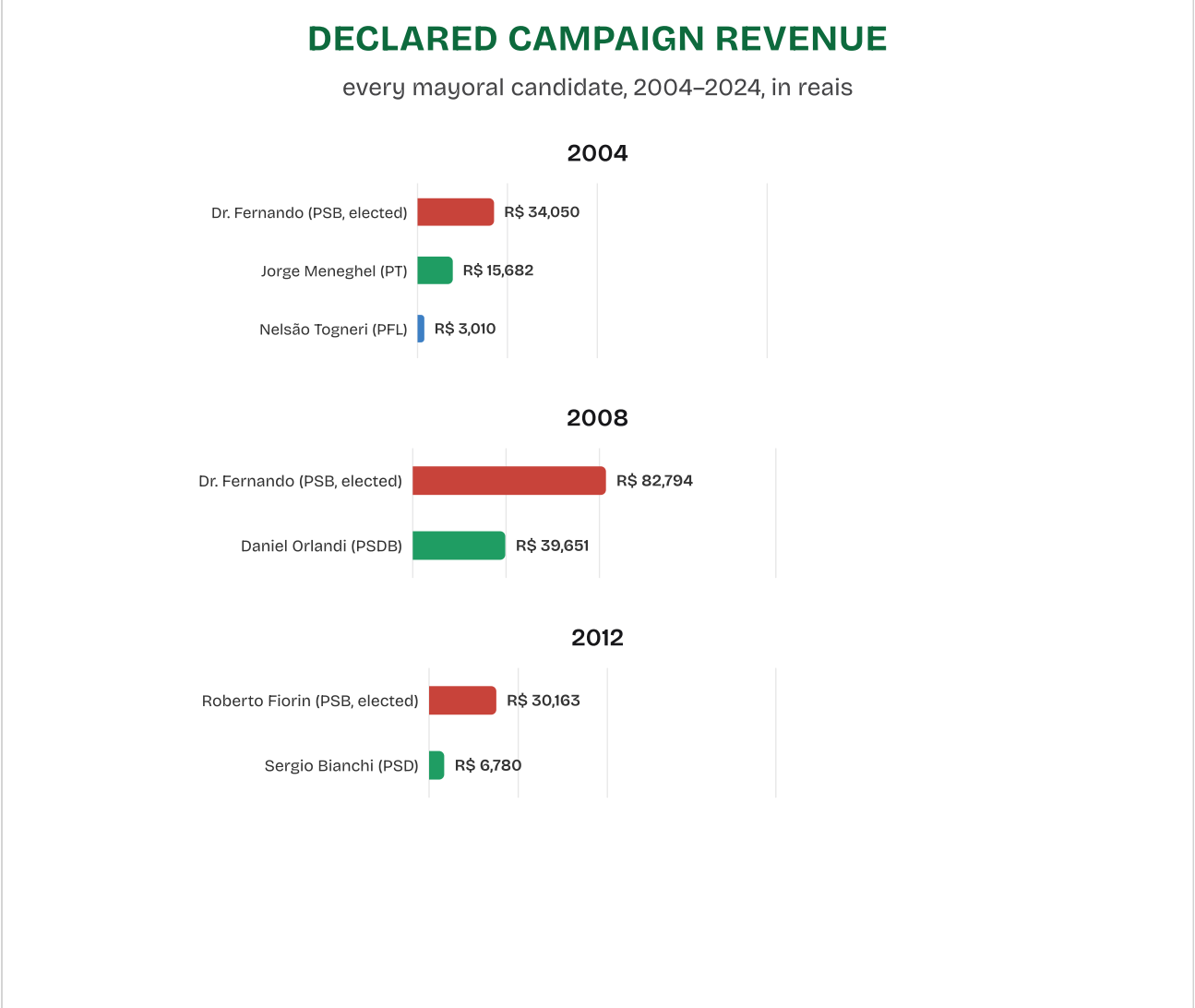
Source: `votacao_secao`, TSE, 2020 and 2024. "Group," for council races, defined by the same parties as the methodological note below. Pearson correlation (r) on the share of valid votes per precinct; includes straight-party votes (a vote for the party with no named candidate), attributed to the party voted for.

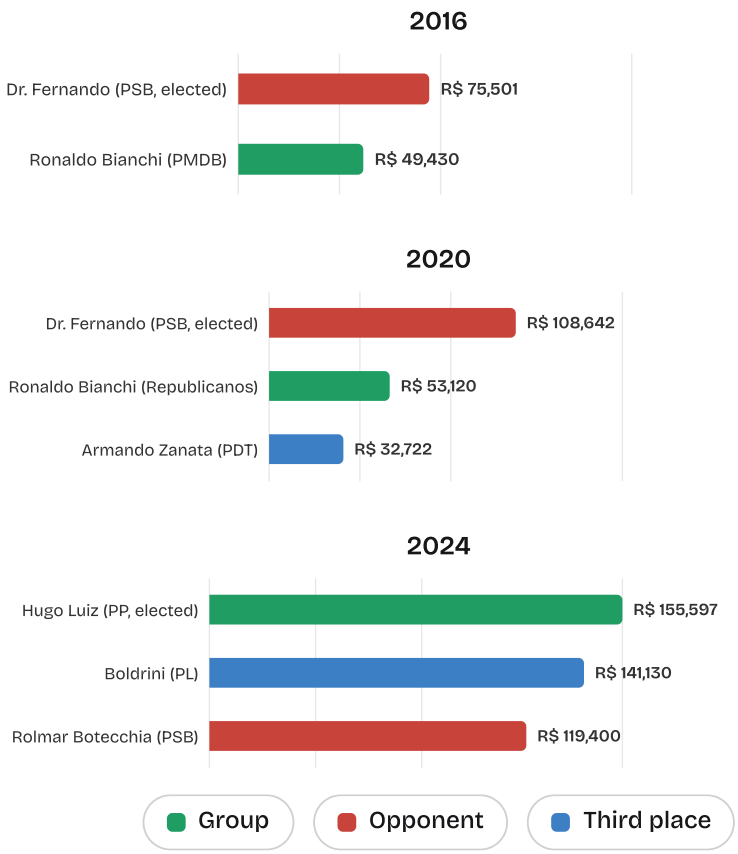
Methodological note. Since proportional coalitions (for council seats) were abolished starting in 2020, each candidate runs alone under a single party. Each candidate's "side" was determined by membership in the parties that made up Hugo Luiz's majoritarian coalition each year (PTB/Republicanos/Patriota in 2020; Republicanos/PP/PSDB in 2024). It isn't a formal proportional-slate tie: that hasn't existed in this form since the 2017 electoral reform.

WHAT IT COST, AND WHO SHOWED UP TO VOTE

Data from the TSE's **electoral campaign finance filings** (revenue and expenses declared by every candidate, opponents included) and its **turnout breakdown** (attendance and abstention) round out the picture: the turnaround didn't come from a bigger electorate, and the revenue raised by the group's candidacy was only the largest among the competitors in 2024. In the five earlier defeats, the winner declared 1.5 to 4.4 times more revenue than the group's candidate. Even so, the group's campaign converted the money into votes more efficiently than any other candidate for the office in 2008, 2012, 2016, 2020 and 2024; in 2004 it was the second most efficient. The two figures below show every mayoral candidate of the six elections.

FIGURE 12 Declared campaign revenue: every mayoral candidate, 2004–2024



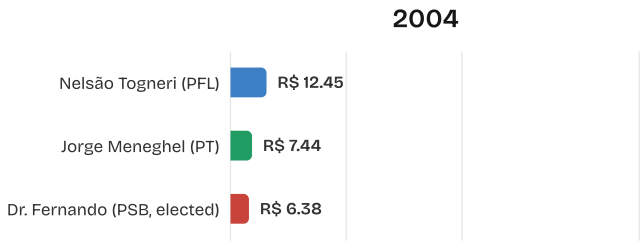


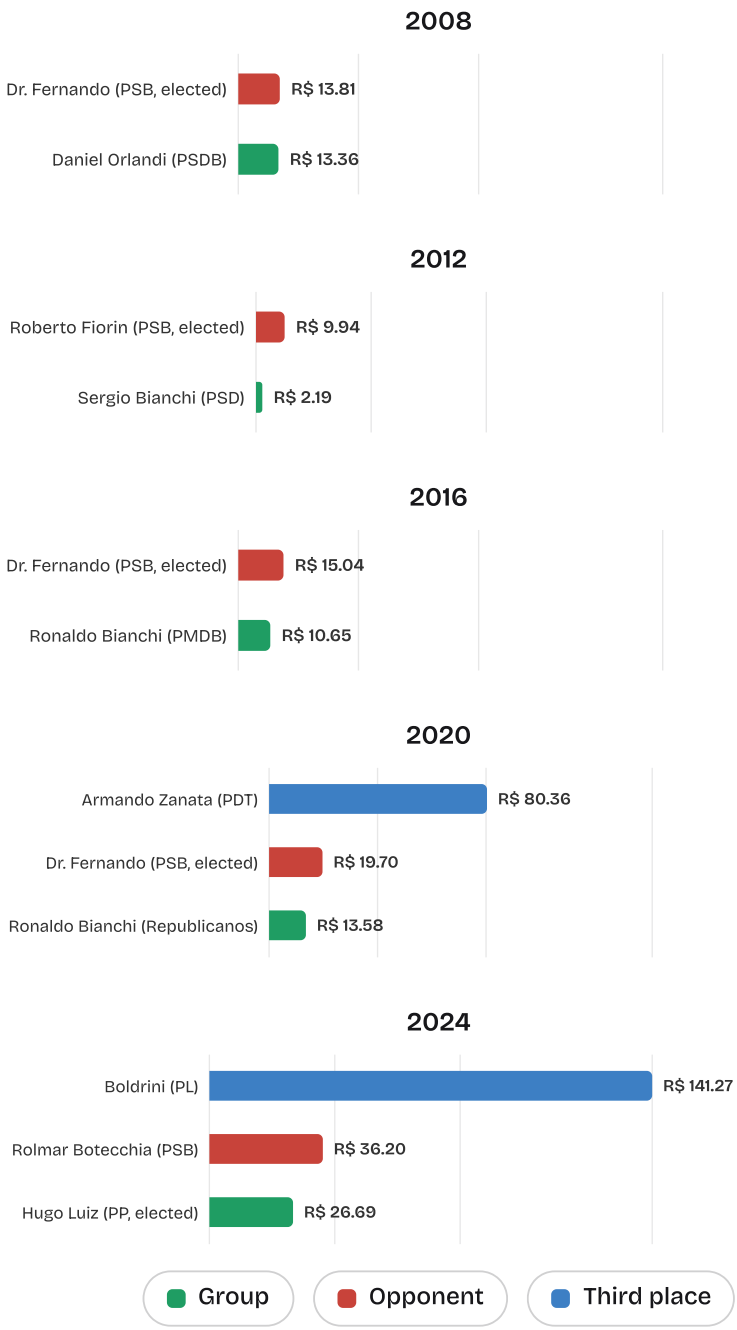
With every candidate side by side, the group only had the largest revenue in 2024. In the five defeats, the winner declared more: R$ 34 thousand against R$ 16 thousand in 2004, R$ 83 thousand against R$ 40 thousand in 2008, R$ 30 thousand against R$ 7 thousand in 2012, R$ 76 thousand against R$ 49 thousand in 2016 and R$ 109 thousand against R$ 53 thousand in 2020. In 2024, Hugo Luiz had the largest revenue of the three (R$ 156 thousand), but the gap to Boldrini (R$ 141 thousand) and Rolmar Botecchia (R$ 119 thousand) was small. Luiz Teixeira (PV, 2004) does not appear: he is missing from the campaign accounts in the extract.

FIGURE 13 Spending efficiency per vote: every mayoral candidate, 2004–2024

SPENDING EFFICIENCY PER VOTE

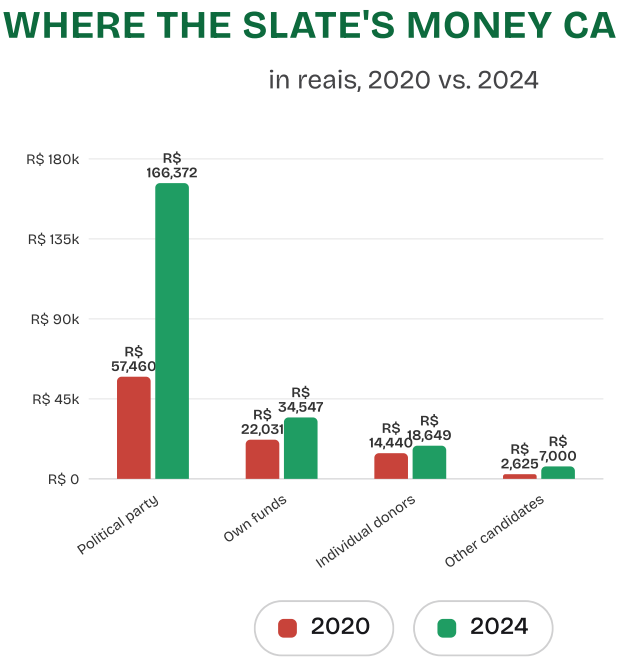
reais spent per vote (the lower, the more efficient), every mayoral candidate, 2004–2024





Honesty about the data: the group's spending per vote rose from R$ 2.19 (2012) to R$ 26.69 (2024), and in 2004 the group was the second most efficient (R$ 7.44, against R$ 6.38 for the winner, Dr. Fernando). In every other election, 2008, 2012, 2016, 2020 and 2024, the group's candidacy was the **most efficient among the competitors**, including in 2024, when it won spending R$ 26.69 per vote against R$ 36.20 (Rolmar Botecchia) and R$ 141.27 (Boldrini, the worst conversion efficiency of the race). In 2012, Roberto Fiorin's paid expenses exceed his declared revenue, as recorded in the extracts.

FIGURE 14 Where the slate's money came from

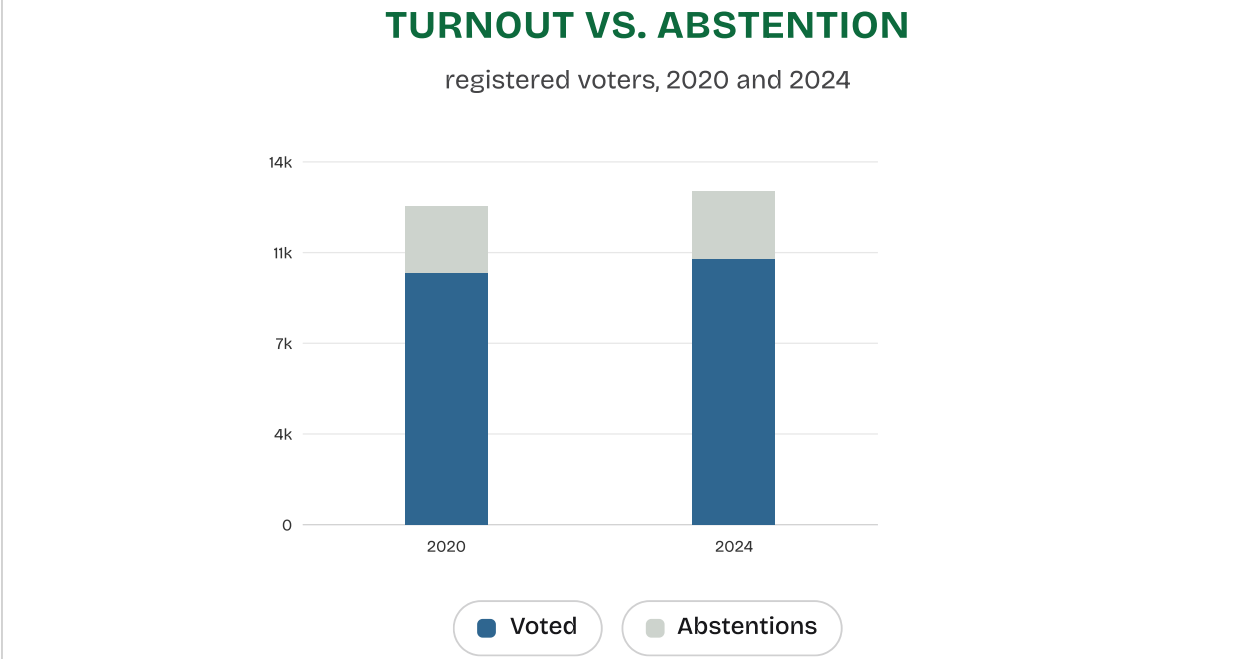


Political-party funds (Party Fund / FEFC) dominate both elections and tripled in absolute terms, from R$57.5 thousand to R$166.4 thousand, reflecting the growth of the national election fund between the two races, not necessarily a campaign strategy choice.

Turnout doesn't explain the 2024 turnaround, but it's been falling for twenty years

Between 2020 and 2024, the registered electorate grew just 4.6% (12,294 → 12,860) and turnout stayed practically flat: **79.15% in 2020, 79.74% in 2024**. Since the slate's candidate grew 57% in absolute votes (3,681 → 5,779) while the total electorate barely moved, the turnaround was predominantly **conversion of voters who already voted**, not mobilization of new ones.

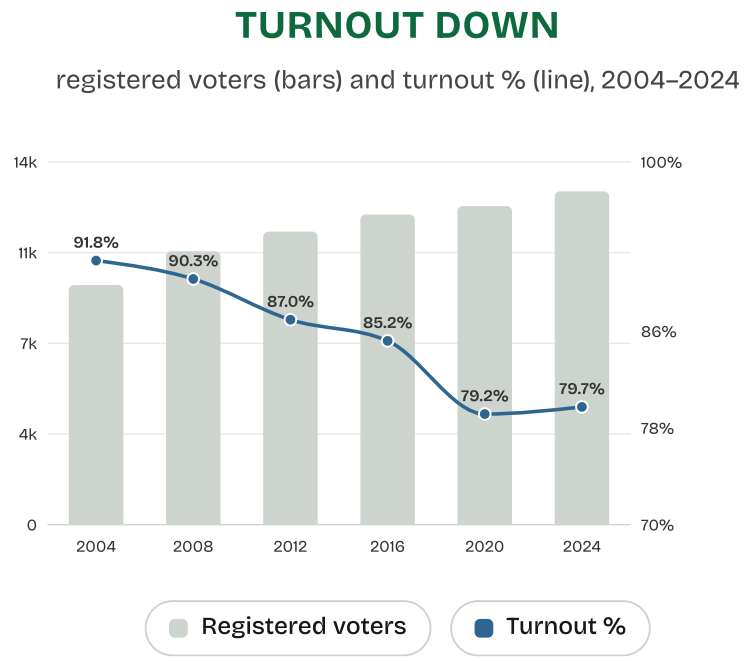
FIGURE 15 Turnout vs. abstention



Blank votes (201 → 122) and null votes (317 → 178) also fell, a sign of less protest voting or disengagement in 2024.

Across all six elections, though, turnout isn't flat: it fell steadily, from 91.8% in 2004 to the 79-80% range of 2020 and 2024. The registered electorate grew 39% over that same period (2004: 9,247; 2024: 12,860), but the number of people who actually voted grew far less, 20.8% (2004: 8,492; 2024: 10,255), because a growing share of registered voters stopped showing up.

FIGURE 16 Turnout down, even as the electorate grew



Turnout fell almost 12 percentage points in twenty years, and only stopped falling between 2020 and 2024. The registered electorate grew (more people eligible to vote), but the share who actually show up shrank, a national pattern of declining participation, not an effect of the campaign studied here.

Source: `detalhe_votacao_munzona`, TSE, mayoral race, all six elections (2004 to 2024).

Electorate profile: almost nothing changed

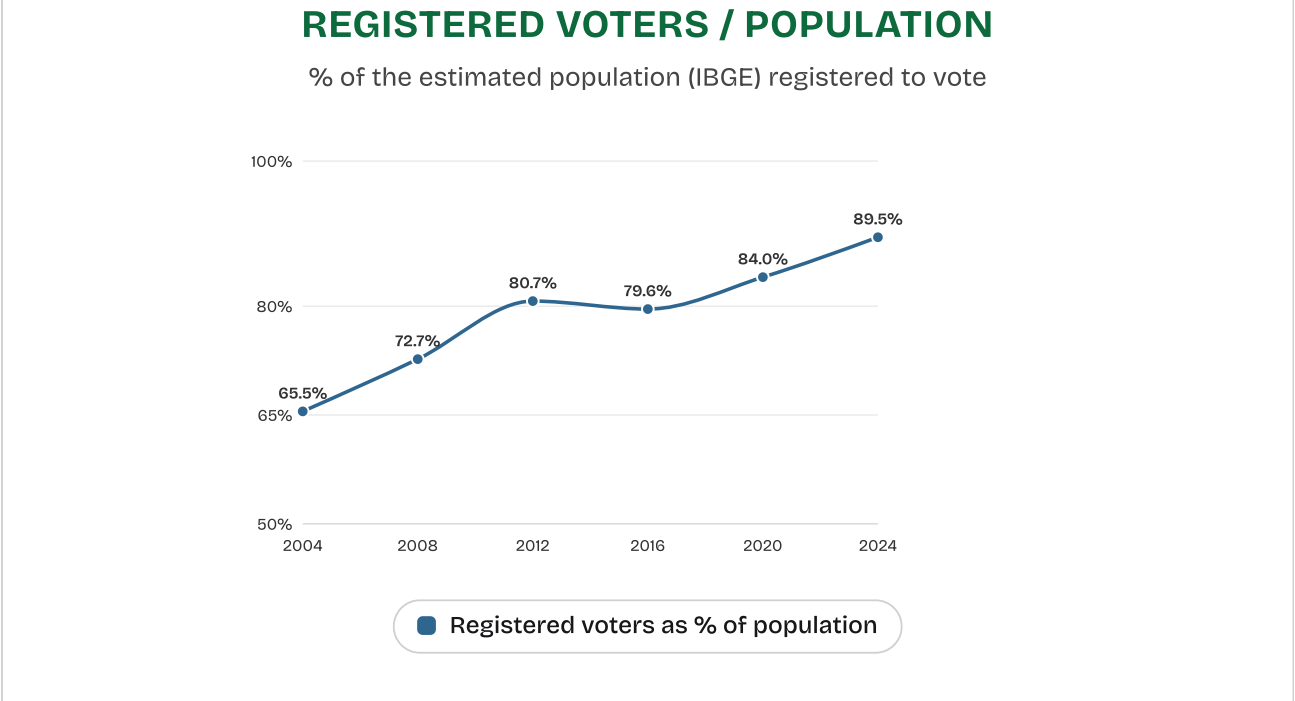
The electorate's demographic profile (`perfil_eleitor_secao` data, TSE) also stayed stable over time. The gender split has been slowly converging toward parity every election: 51.7% men / 48.2% women in 2008, 51.1% / 48.8% in 2012, 50.6% / 49.3% in 2016, 50.2% / 49.7% in 2020, and 49.9% / 50.0% in 2024 (the TSE never published this figure for 2004). Practically fifty-fifty all along, with a steady trend toward a slight female majority.

A data curiosity. The number of voters aged 16 to 24 was **exactly 1,225 in 2020 and 1,225 in 2024**: same age bracket, same total, two different elections. It's a real coincidence, confirmed row by row in the official TSE database. It has no obvious causal explanation, but it rules out the idea that the turnaround was driven by a wave of newly-registered young voters: the municipality's young-voter base simply neither grew nor shrank between the two elections.

Cross-referencing with IBGE: the electorate grew, the population didn't

To understand whether the electorate's growth (9,247 registered in 2004 → 12,860 in 2024, +39%) reflects the municipality growing, we cross-referenced TSE data with IBGE's annual population estimates (SIDRA, table 6579, municipality code 3200300). The answer is no: Alfredo Chaves' estimated population stayed practically flat over the period (14,113 in 2004, ~14,373 in 2024), with dips in some years. The electorate didn't grow because the municipality grew. It grew because an increasing share of the population already living there became registered to vote.

FIGURE 17 Registered voters as % of estimated population (IBGE)



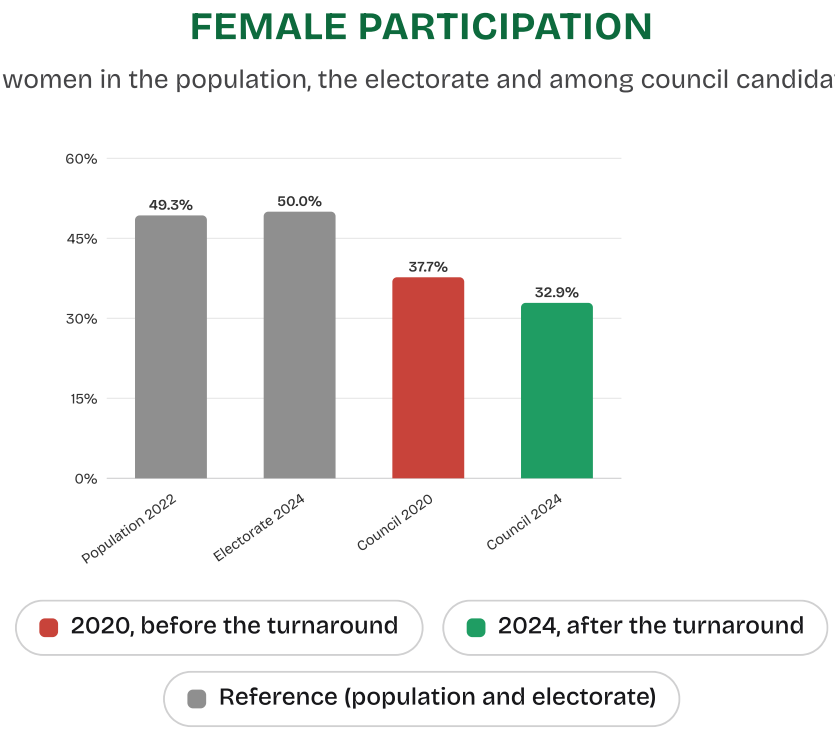
Electorate coverage of the total population jumped from 65.5% (2004) to 89.5% (2024), a national effect of demographic transition and biometric registration, not a phenomenon local to Alfredo Chaves. Source: IBGE SIDRA, table 6579 (estimated resident population), cross-referenced with the TSE's QT_APTOS figure per year.

Sex, race and income: do candidates look like the people who live here?

IBGE's 2022 Demographic Census (SIDRA, tables 9514 and 9605) makes it possible to go beyond total population and cross-reference sex and race/color with who actually runs for office. Alfredo Chaves' population is 49.3% women and 50.7% men, 61.4% white, 34.3% mixed-race ("pardo") and 4.2% Black, numbers very close to the registered electorate's, which is also moving toward gender parity. Among candidates, though, the picture diverges: of the 69 council candidates in 2020, 37.7% were women; in 2024, out of 70 candidates, that

share fell to 32.9%, the opposite of the electorate's trend, which keeps moving closer to 50%. Mayoral candidates are left out of these percentages: there are only three per election, and in both 2020 and 2024 all three were men.

FIGURE 18 Female participation: population, electorate and council candidates



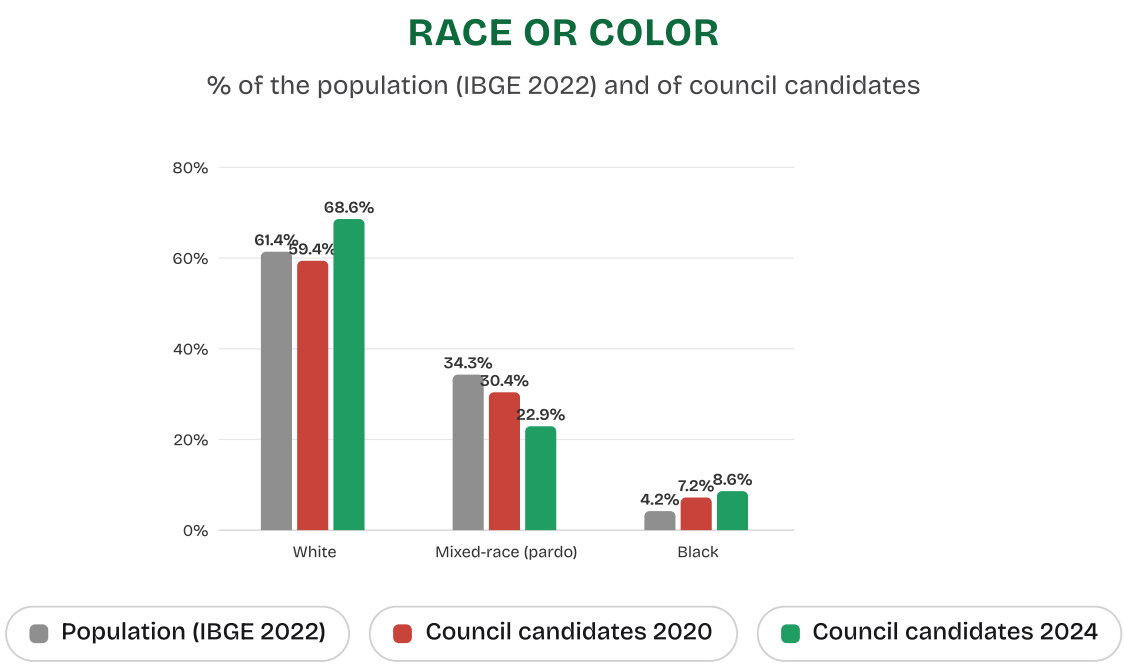
Population and electorate are practically 50/50; among council candidates, the share of women is far smaller, and fell even further from 2020 to 2024.

A name behind the number. The Alfredo Chaves City Council's own legislative record (Commendation Motion No. 003/2024, authored by then-council-member and now-mayor Hugo Luiz) honors **Regina Puppin** as "the first and only Council member of the Municipality of Alfredo Chaves to hold a seat in the Municipal Legislature", in other words, the only woman ever to hold a Council seat in the municipality's history, to this day. She doesn't appear among any of the council candidates the TSE registered between 2004 and 2024 consulted for this study, which indicates her term predates that period. The gap in female representation on the Council is older and deeper than the six elections analyzed here.

The racial composition of the council candidacies follows a similar pattern. In 2020, white candidates were 59.4% of the total, close to the municipality's population share of 61.4%. By 2024 that share rose to 68.6%, while mixed-race candidates fell from 30.4% to 22.9%: a drift

away from Alfredo Chaves' racial composition, even as the share of Black candidates grew slightly (7.2% → 8.6%). Among mayoral candidates, all three in 2020 were white; in 2024, two of the three were white and one was mixed-race.

FIGURE 19 Race or color: population vs. council candidates



In 2020, council candidates' racial composition was almost a mirror of the population's. By 2024, white candidates were over-represented and mixed-race candidates, under-represented.

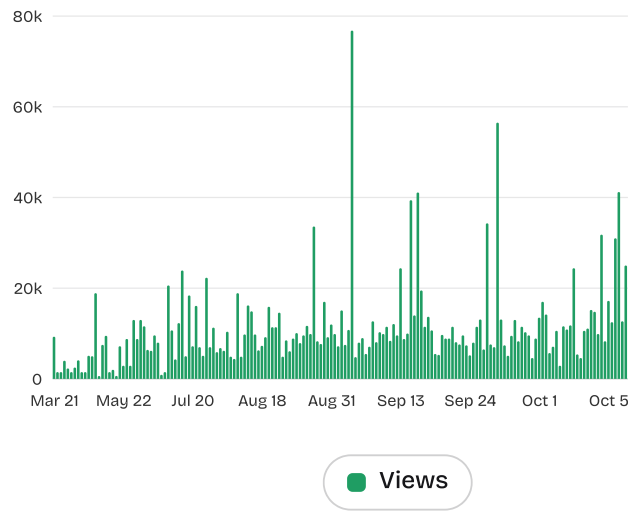
07 · DIGITAL CAMPAIGN

WHAT THE POSTS SHOW ABOUT THE RACE

This section steps outside the TSE dataset and uses a different source: the post history of the candidacy's official Instagram account (@hugoluiz11_), from the day of party affiliation through the election result. It isn't public, auditable data like the rest of this study. It's the campaign's own archive, reviewed post by post from screenshots exported from the app, with date, views, likes, comments and shares for each publication. We treat these numbers the way the campaign team saw them in real time: a measure of organic reach and engagement, not voting intention.

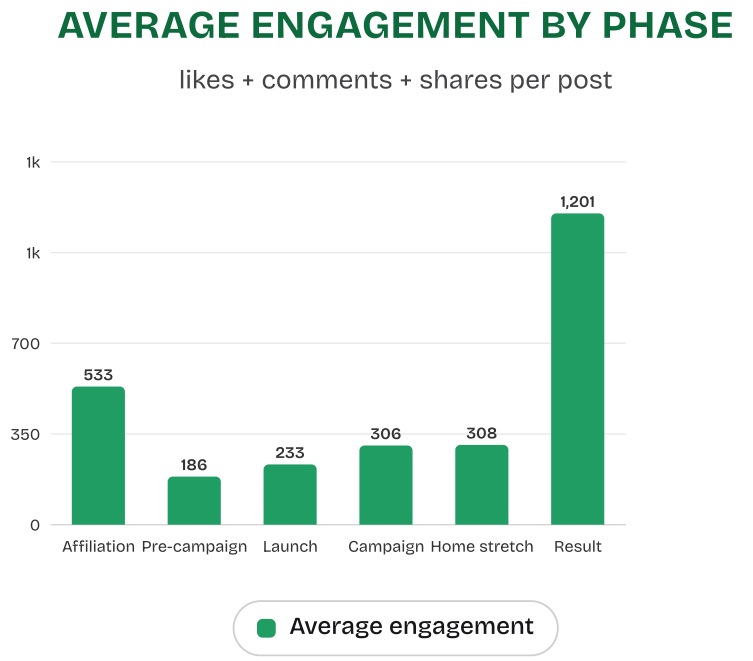
The timeline covers six milestones: **affiliation to Progressistas (PP)** on March 21, 2024; the **pre-candidacy launch** on June 7; the **running-mate announcement** for Cleber Bianchi, at the August 3 party convention; the public dispute over a **suspended poll** on September 22; the **win** on October 6; and the thank-you post for **5,779 votes**, published hours after the result: the highest-engagement post of the entire campaign.

FIGURE 20 Views per post, affiliation through the win



Routine pre-campaign posts (April to May) range between 1,500 and 19,000 views. In the home stretch (September and October), peaks of 30,000 to 56,000 views become common: more than 4× the average reach from earlier in the year.

FIGURE 21 Average engagement by campaign phase



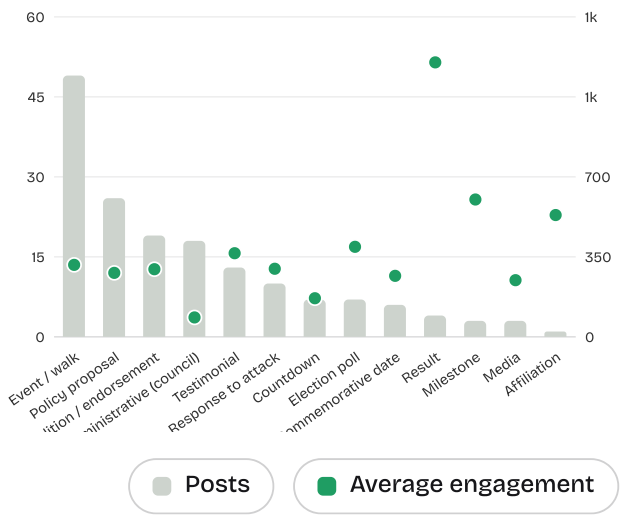
Average engagement per post nearly quintuples between the pre-campaign and the result phase, driven mostly by celebration photos and the thank-you post on election night. Affiliation, in March, is a single outlier post (533): too small a sample to draw a conclusion on its own.

We classified every one of the 166 posts identified by content type, to understand not just when reach grew, but what the campaign was actually posting. **Street events and walks** are the most common format (nearly a third of posts), followed by policy proposals, coalition posts, and routine administrative communication from the council-member term (City Council session notices, which the campaign posted in pairs: an invite beforehand, an explainer video after). But volume isn't the same as engagement: **voter testimonials**, which appear far less often, engage well above average, more than four times routine administrative communication.

FIGURE 22 Post volume and engagement by content type

VOLUME AND ENGAGEMENT BY CONTENT TYPE

posts published (bars) and average engagement per post (dots)



Administrative posts (City Council session notices) are one of the most frequent formats, but the one that engages least: the audience reacts more to people talking about people (testimonials) than to routine institutional communication.

166

distinct posts identified across both files supplied, reviewed one by one and cross-checked against the total screenshot count

1.86M

combined views across the posts reviewed, March to October 2024

1,841

likes + comments + shares on the highest-engagement post, the thank-you for 5,779 votes

Limits of this data. Unlike the rest of this study, this section doesn't come from a public, auditable repository: it's a manual read of screenshots from the campaign's own post history, without access to the Instagram API or to paid-reach, impression, or audience-demographic metrics. We reviewed all 166 screenshots in both files supplied (90 and 76 pages) and identified 166 distinct posts with legible date, views, likes, comments and shares - a cross-check by like and comment counts confirmed each screenshot maps to exactly one post, with no duplicates. The content-type classification is ours, made from each post's caption and format, not an Instagram-native category. A handful of older administrative posts' dates (April to August) were estimated from their position in the timeline where the capture didn't show one clearly. View and engagement counts are whatever Instagram displayed at the moment of capture, not necessarily each post's final total, which keeps changing as it continues to receive interactions.

08 · CANDIDATE PROFILE

WHO THE CANDIDATES WERE, BEYOND THE VOTES

`consulta_cand` and `bem_candidato` data (TSE) bring age, education, occupation and declared assets for each candidate: public information, required by law at every election. Table 8.1 gathers the 16 mayoral candidates of the six elections, from 2004 to 2024, and Figures 23 and 24 compare them. The contrast with Hugo Luiz is the sharpest in the entire study.

TABLE 8.1 Profile of every mayoral candidate, 2004–2024

WHO THE CANDIDATES WERE

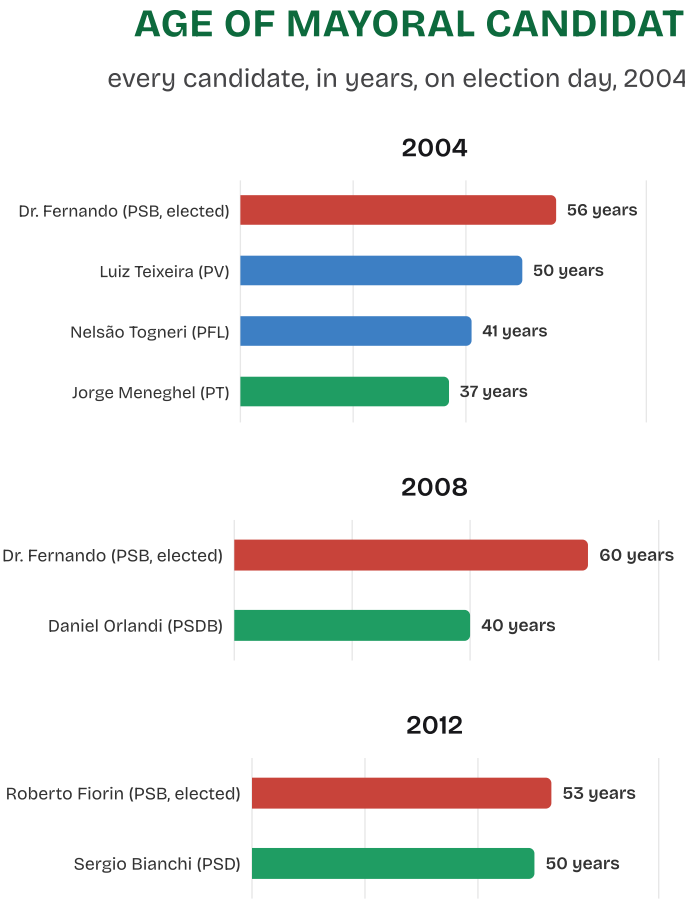
age on election day, education and occupation from the candidacy registry, declared assets from the TSE

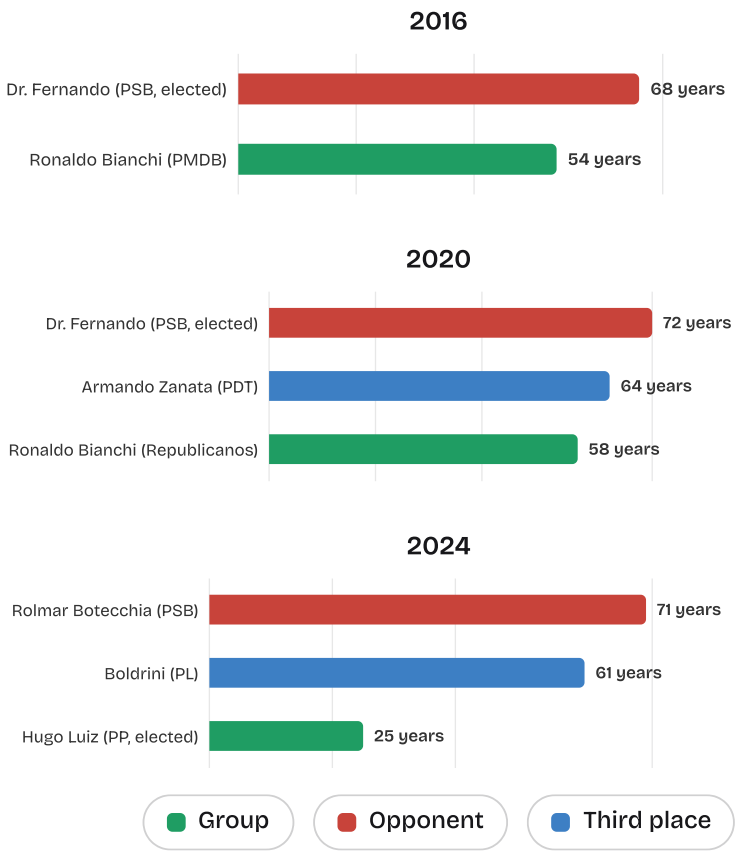
YEAR	CANDIDATE	AGE	EDUCATION	DECLARED OCCUPATION	DECLARED ASSETS
2004	Dr. Fernando (PSB)	56	College degree	Physician	—
2004	Jorge Meneghel (PT)	37	College degree	School teacher (primary and secondary)	—
2004	Luiz Teixeira (PV)	50	College degree	Lawyer	—
2004	Nelsão Togneri (PFL)	41	High school	Building technician	—
2008	Dr. Fernando (PSB)	60	College degree	Physician	R$ 53,416
2008	Daniel Orlandi (PSDB)	40	High school	Farmer	R$ 15,000
2012	Roberto Fiorin (PSB)	53	College degree	Federal civil servant	R$ 284,406
2012	Sergio Bianchi (PSD)	50	Primary school, incomplete	Councilor	R$ 20,000
2016	Dr. Fernando (PSB)	68	College degree	Physician	R$ 410,500

YEAR	CANDIDATE	AGE	EDUCATION	DECLARED OCCUPATION	DECLARED ASSETS
2016	Ronaldo Bianchi (PMDB)	54	High school	Businessman	R$ 428,561
2020	Dr. Fernando (PSB)	72	College degree	Mayor	R$ 620,761
2020	Ronaldo Bianchi (Republicanos)	58	High school	Businessman	R$ 366,381
2020	Armando Zanata (PDT)	64	High school, incomplete	Businessman	R$ 1,380,000
2024	Hugo Luiz (PP)	25	College degree	Lawyer	R$ 29,573
2024	Rolmar Botecchia (PSB)	71	High school	Cattle rancher	R$ 718,421
2024	Boldrini (PL)	61	High school	Merchant	R$ 0

A dash (—) marks data that does not exist in the extracts: the assets dataset does not cover 2004. Each candidate's revenue and spending efficiency per vote are in Figures 12 and 13.

FIGURE 23 Age of mayoral candidates

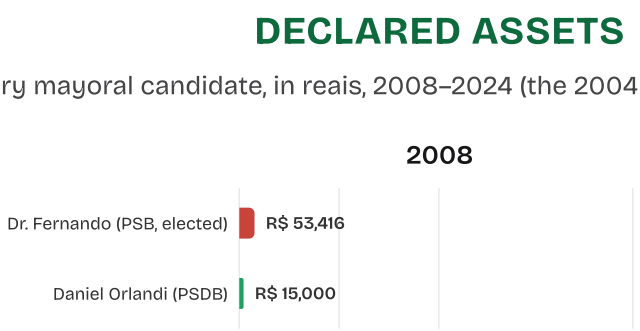


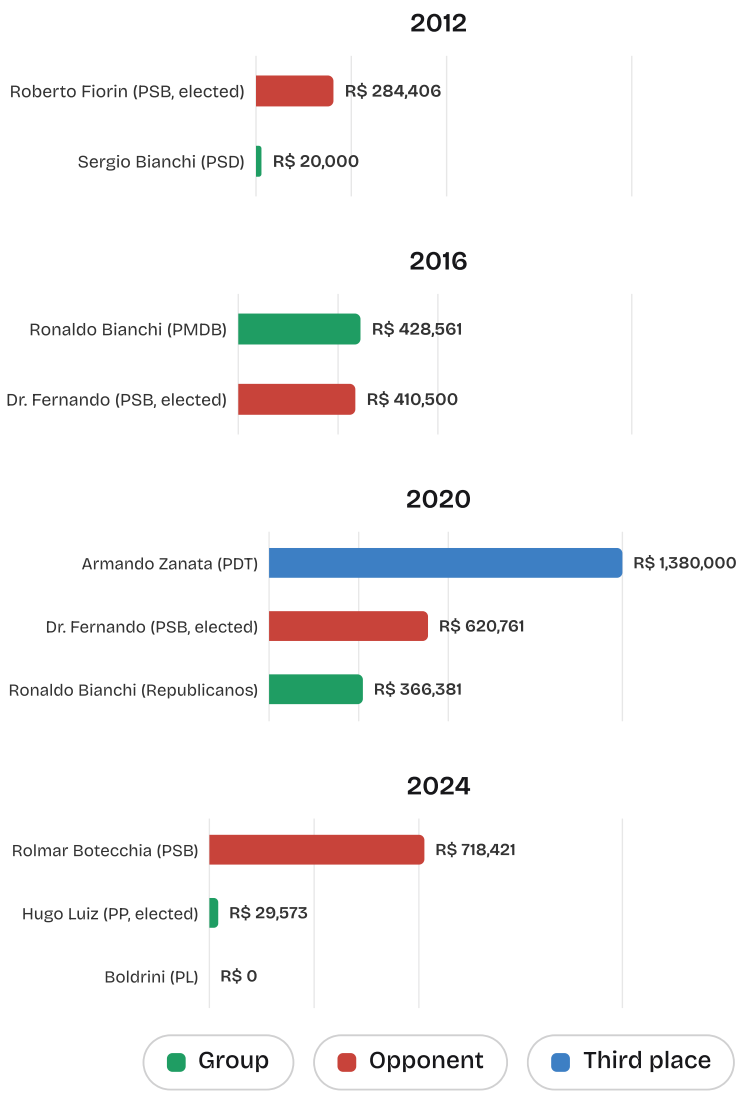


In each of the five defeats, the group's candidate was younger than the winner: 37 against 56 in 2004, 40 against 60 in 2008, 50 against 53 in 2012, 54 against 68 in 2016 and 58 against 72 in 2020. In 2024 the gap is extreme: Hugo Luiz, at 25, was 36 years younger than Boldrini (61) and 46 years younger than Rolmar Botecchia (71). The average age of *every* candidate in the race (mayor and council combined) was the same in the last two elections (50.2 years in both 2020 and 2024): the municipality didn't get younger. Only the winning candidacy did.

Hugo Luiz was 25 on election day in 2024, holds a law degree from UFES, and, per the TSE's records, is **white and single**. The other two mayoral candidates that year were 61 and 71.

FIGURE 24 Declared assets of mayoral candidates





Hugo Luiz declared **R$ 29,573** in assets, the fourth-smallest among the 12 mayoral candidates with assets in the dataset (2008 to 2024): only Boldrini (R$ 0, in 2024), Daniel Orlandi (R$ 15 thousand, in 2008) and Sergio Bianchi (R$ 20 thousand, in 2012) declared less. That is roughly 24× less than the 2024 runner-up (Rolmar Botecchia, R$ 718 thousand) and 12× less than Ronaldo Bianchi in 2020 (R$ 366 thousand). In 2008, 2012 and 2020 the group's candidate declared less than the winner; in 2016, more (R$ 429 thousand against R$ 411 thousand).

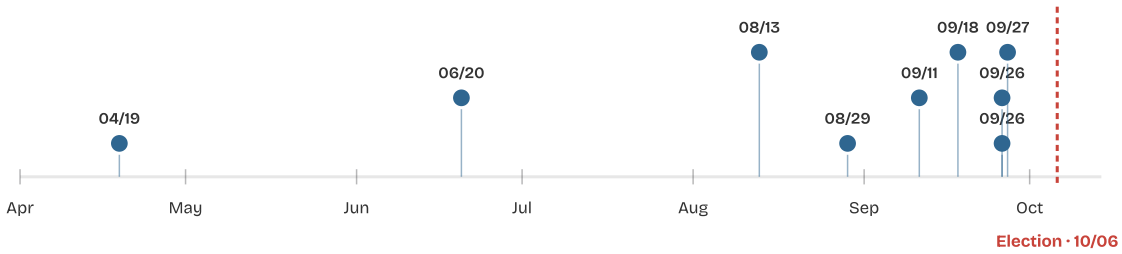
The 9 registered election polls

The TSE maintains its own system for registering election polls (pesqele-divulgacao.tse.jus.br), required under Article 33 of Law 9,504/97. For Alfredo Chaves in 2024, **9 polls** are on record, from 5 different firms, between April and September. We opened and read all 9 registration filings in PDF. It's worth noting a real limit of the public data: **the TSE doesn't publish the result** (voting-intention percentage per candidate) in these filings, only formal confirmation of registration (firm, protocol, date, scope). It's the commissioning firm that releases the result, typically through a local press outlet.

FIGURE 25 Registration of the 9 election polls: timeline

REGISTRATION OF THE 9 ELECTION POLLS

timeline of registrations with the TSE, 2024



04/19/2024	Solução Treinamento Mkt e Pesquisas	ES-09808/2024
06/20/2024	I9 - Inove Consultoria	ES-03038/2024
08/13/2024	Direta Propaganda e Eventos	ES-03088/2024
08/29/2024	Instituto Verita	ES-08806/2024
09/11/2024	Direta Propaganda e Eventos	ES-08536/2024
09/18/2024	I9 - Inove Consultoria	ES-04825/2024
09/26/2024	Direta Propaganda e Eventos	ES-08726/2024
09/26/2024	Ipopes Pesquisa de Opinião	ES-00808/2024
09/27/2024	I9 - Inove Consultoria	ES-06358/2024

The pace of registrations picks up in the last 6 weeks before the election: 5 of the 9 polls were registered in September, a sign of a race competitive enough to justify polls commissioned by multiple firms in sequence.

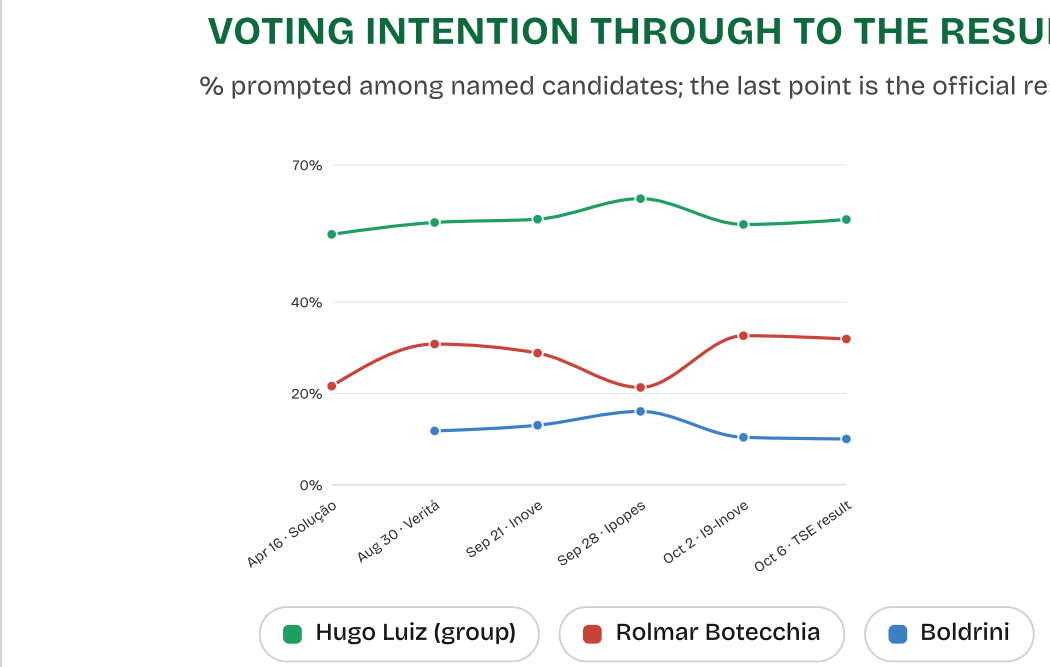
We located the original document for **6 of the 9** polls: the full reports each institute produced for its client, with methodology, sample size and margin of error. Two of them (Apr 16 and Sep 21) had also been released to the press; the other four are real data, but restricted in circulation, never published by a press outlet:

- **Apr 15–16, 2024**: Instituto Solução (TSE ES-09808/2024), 403 respondents, 4.9 p.p. margin, commissioned by AQUI NOTÍCIAS.COM (released).
- **Aug 29–31, 2024**: Instituto Veritá (TSE ES-08806/2024), 352 respondents, 5.5 p.p. margin, commissioned by Marataízes Piúma Iriri Internet Ltda. (not publicly released).

- **Sep 17, 2024**: no institute or TSE registration number appears on the document (an atypical result, see the note below).
- **Sep 20–21, 2024**: Inove Consultoria (TSE ES-04825/2024), 574 respondents, 4.0 p.p. margin, commissioned by H.A. Comunicações Ltda. (released by Montanhas Capixabas).
- **Sep 27–29, 2024**: Ipopes Pesquisa de Opinião Pública, 400 respondents (not publicly released).
- **Oct 1–2, 2024**: I9-Inove Consultoria (TSE ES-06358/2024), 373 respondents, 5.0 p.p. margin, commissioned by Portal ES Agora (not publicly released).

The six real-data points don't share one calculation basis: the Aug 29–31 poll and the official Oct 6 result sum to 100% among the three named candidates, but the Sep 20–21, Sep 27–29 and Oct 1–2 polls (the three 3-way polls with a gap) leave 9.6 to 23.75 percentage points unassigned, a sign those three report the share of the total sample (undecided included), not the share among named candidates. We normalize those three to sum to 100% among the names polled. The Apr 16 poll is different: it only had 2 names (Boldrini wasn't a candidate yet), and normalizing a 2-way race would artificially inflate both existing names, so that point appears with its raw value, as reported in the original document.

FIGURE 26 Voting-intention trajectory (prompted) through to the result



In **5 of the 6** polls with real data, **Hugo Luiz** never left the lead: between 54.8% and 62.6% voting intention, from the start of the campaign to the end, always at least 24 points ahead of the runner-up. The exception is the isolated Sep 17 data point (marked with an asterisk*), where the roles reverse (Rolmar 60.0%, Hugo 25.8%). We kept the point on the chart for transparency, but don't treat it as reliable.

* A result out of step with the other 5 polls and the final result; the document carries no TSE registration number or identified institute.

Data notes. One of the registered polls (Direta Propaganda e Eventos) was obtained, but the document referred to a different municipality (Conceição do Castelo, ES), likely a filing error on the commissioning firm's side, so it wasn't used here. **2 of the 9** registered polls still have no document located. The full biographical profile of 2020 candidates required downloading an entire 85 MB national file (no partial-download support), which worked, but more slowly and less elegantly than the rest of the pipeline.

After the election: approval of the administration

This data comes from opinion polling, not the ballot box, and so falls outside the official TSE-based pipeline that underlies the rest of this study. Still, it helps round out the picture. In March 2026, already in the second year of the term, the **Espírito Santo Institute for Research and Statistics (IPESES)** surveyed 405 voters across the seat and districts of Alfredo Chaves (Mar 11–12, 2026, margin of error 4.9 p.p., 95% confidence, quotas by sex and age).

75.0%
approve of Mayor Hugo Luiz's administration (13.0% disapprove; 12.0% didn't know)

70.2%
consider Hugo Luiz an honest person (6.9% disagree; 23.0% didn't know)

63.3%
consider the administration transparent (21.7% disagree; 15.1% don't know)

59.4%
would vote for him again, if choosing today (19.4% wouldn't; 21.2% don't know)

51.3%
say he's keeping his campaign promises (23.7% say partially; 15.1% say no)

48.5%
would vote for governor, senator or state deputy candidates he backs

71.2%
say Alfredo Chaves is on the right track

72.4%
approve of the administration's education record

65.8%
approve of its public health record

Sources: Aqui Notícias, Imprensa Capixaba and Informe Capixaba, all from March 2026, reporting the same IPESES poll.

09 · FULL BREAKDOWN

PRECINCT BY PRECINCT, WITH POLLING LOCATION

The complete table of the mayoral candidacy's valid-vote share in every voting precinct, across both elections, plus the **physical polling location** of each precinct in 2024 (school, community hall, or church, per the TSE's official registry). Rows highlighted in green mark precincts that moved from a loss to an absolute majority. Raw vote counts and totals per precinct are in the repository's underlying data; here, the percentage already tells the story.

PRECINCT	POLLING LOCATION	% 2020	% 2024	CHANGE	
1	EMEF ANA ARAÚJO	37.8%	52.1%	+14.3 p.p.	flipped
2	EMEF ANA ARAÚJO	42.4%	54.3%	+11.9 p.p.	flipped
3	EMEF ANA ARAÚJO	41.1%	51.3%	+10.2 p.p.	flipped
4	EMEF ANA ARAÚJO	40.9%	57.7%	+16.8 p.p.	flipped
5	EMEF ANA ARAÚJO	—	57.5%	—	new precinct
6	EEEFM CAMILA MOTA	42.8%	54.6%	+11.8 p.p.	flipped
7	EEEFM CAMILA MOTA	42.1%	57.3%	+15.2 p.p.	flipped

PRECINCT	POLLING LOCATION	% 2020	% 2024	CHANGE	
8	EEEFM CAMILA MOTA	45.5%	54.4%	+8.9 p.p.	flipped
9	EMEF FAZENDA APARECIDA	58.2%	72.3%	+14.1 p.p.	
10	EEEF DE CRUBIXÁ	32.5%	44.6%	+12.1 p.p.	
11	EEEF DE CRUBIXÁ	34.5%	44.8%	+10.3 p.p.	
12	EMEF ENGANO	42.2%	63.2%	+21.0 p.p.	flipped
13	EMEF ENGANO	37.5%	63.4%	+25.9 p.p.	flipped
14	SALÃO DA IGREJA CATÓLICA DE SÃO FRANCISCO DE BATATAL	47.4%	52.7%	+5.3 p.p.	flipped
15	SALÃO DA IGREJA DE SÃO MARTINHO	35.9%	53.1%	+17.2 p.p.	flipped
16	PRÉDIO DA ANTIGA ESCOLA ALMERINDA BRUNORO	36.2%	43.9%	+7.7 p.p.	
17	EMEF FELIPE MODOLO	46.9%	65.7%	+18.8 p.p.	flipped
18	EMEF FELIPE MODOLO	40.2%	62.0%	+21.8 p.p.	flipped
19	SALÃO COMUNITÁRIO DE NOVA ESTRELA	35.4%	55.0%	+19.6 p.p.	flipped
20	SALÃO DA IGREJA CATÓLICA DE CACHOEIRA ALTA	37.8%	57.0%	+19.2 p.p.	flipped
21	EMUEF QUARTO TERRITÓRIO	31.1%	55.9%	+24.8 p.p.	flipped
22	EMEF SAGRADA FAMÍLIA	31.6%	58.0%	+26.4 p.p.	flipped
23	EMEF SAGRADA FAMÍLIA	32.8%	57.5%	+24.7 p.p.	flipped
24	SALÃO COMUNITÁRIO DE SÃO BENTO DE URÂNIA	44.5%	68.8%	+24.3 p.p.	flipped
25	EMEF FELIPE MODOLO	27.8%	48.2%	+20.4 p.p.	
26	EEUEF VILA NOVA DE MARAVILHA	43.8%	64.7%	+20.9 p.p.	flipped
27	EEEFM CAMILA MOTA	45.3%	55.7%	+10.4 p.p.	flipped
28	SALÃO DA IGREJA DE SÃO MARTINHO	39.8%	55.8%	+16.0 p.p.	flipped
29	SALÃO COMUNITÁRIO DE SÃO BENTO DE URÂNIA	43.5%	63.7%	+20.2 p.p.	flipped
30	EEEFM CAMILA MOTA	38.1%	54.9%	+16.8 p.p.	flipped
31	EEEFM CAMILA MOTA	39.6%	59.7%	+20.1 p.p.	flipped
33	EEEFM CAMILA MOTA	—	56.2%	—	new precinct
34	EEEFM CAMILA MOTA	44.4%	59.5%	+15.1 p.p.	flipped
35	EEEFM CAMILA MOTA	46.4%	52.0%	+5.6 p.p.	flipped
37	CRECHE COMECINHO DE GENTE	43.4%	57.2%	+13.8 p.p.	flipped
38	CRECHE PEQUERRUCHOS	—	63.8%	—	new precinct
39	CRECHE PEQUERRUCHOS	—	68.3%	—	new precinct
40	SALÃO PAROQUIAL DA IGREJA DE NOSSA SENHORA DA CONCEIÇÃO	43.6%	67.1%	+23.5 p.p.	flipped
41	SALÃO PAROQUIAL DA IGREJA DE NOSSA SENHORA DA CONCEIÇÃO	40.5%	60.3%	+19.8 p.p.	flipped

PRECINCT	POLLING LOCATION	% 2020	% 2024	CHANGE	
85	CRECHE PEQUERRUCHOS	29.8%	63.3%	+33.5 p.p.	flipped
96	SALÃO COMUNITÁRIO DE SÃO BENTO DE URÂNIA	—	78.9%	—	new precinct
98	EMEF FELIPE MODOLO	—	57.3%	—	new precinct

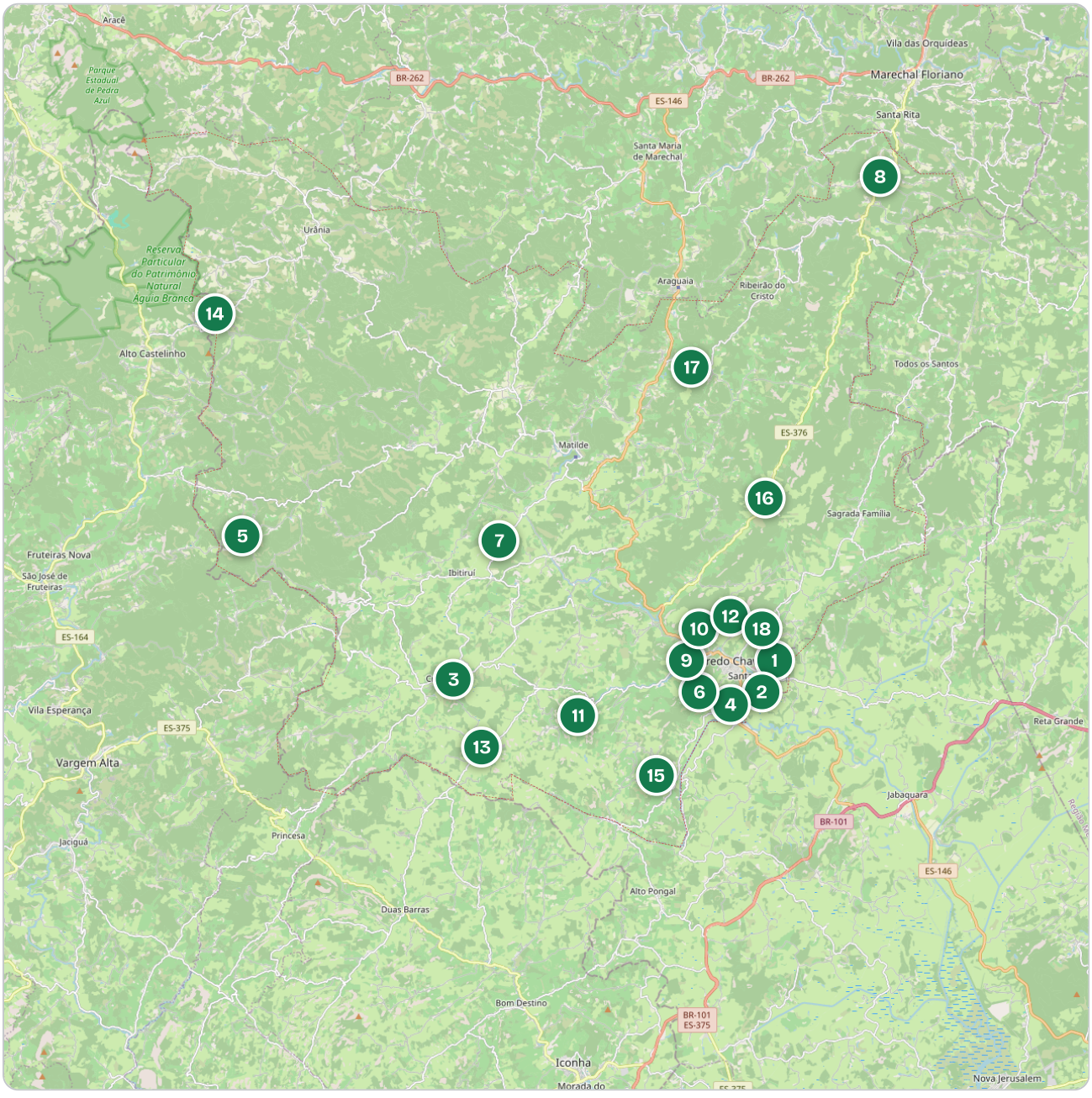
The 18 polling sites of the municipality

Alfredo Chaves' 42 voting precincts are spread across **18 physical polling locations**, between the municipal seat and rural districts, all identified in the TSE's official registry:

#	POLLING LOCATION	ADDRESS	PRECINCTS SERVED
1	CRECHE COMECINHO DE GENTE	AV. DARCY DE PAULA GAIGHER, S/N	37
2	CRECHE PEQUERRUCHOS	RUA ANTÔNIO CLAUDIO GAIGHER, 19	38, 39, 85
3	EEEF DE CRUBIXÁ	R. PRINCIPAL, S/ Nº	10, 11
4	EEEFM CAMILA MOTA	R. NELSON DA COSTA MELLO, S/ N	6, 7, 8, 27, 30, 31, 33, 34, 35
5	EEUEF VILA NOVA DE MARAVILHA	R. PRINCIPAL, S/ Nº	26
6	EMEF ANA ARAÚJO	R. EXPEDICIONARIO OSVALDO SAUDINO	1, 2, 3, 4, 5
7	EMEF ENGANO	R. PRINCIPAL, S/N	12, 13
8	EMEF FAZENDA APARECIDA	R. PRINCIPAL, S/ Nº	9
9	EMEF FELIPE MODOLO	R. PRINCIPAL, S/ N	17, 18, 25, 98
10	EMEF SAGRADA FAMÍLIA	R. PRINCIPAL, S/ N	22, 23
11	EMUEF QUARTO TERRITÓRIO	RUA PRINCIPAL, S/N	21
12	PRÉDIO DA ANTIGA ESCOLA ALMERINDA BRUNORO	R. PRINCIPAL, S/ N	16
13	SALÃO COMUNITÁRIO DE NOVA ESTRELA	R. PRINCIPAL, S/ N	19
14	SALÃO COMUNITÁRIO DE SÃO BENTO DE URÂNIA	R. PRINCIPAL, S/ N	24, 29, 96
15	SALÃO DA IGREJA CATÓLICA DE CACHOEIRA ALTA	R. PRINCIPAL, S/ N	20
16	SALÃO DA IGREJA CATÓLICA DE SÃO FRANCISCO DE BATATAL	RUA PRINCIPAL, S/ N	14
17	SALÃO DA IGREJA DE SÃO MARTINHO	R. PRINCIPAL, S/ N	15, 28
18	SALÃO PAROQUIAL DA IGREJA DE NOSSA SENHORA DA CONCEIÇÃO	AV. GETULIO VARGAS, 545	40, 41

Map of polling locations

The numbers on the map correspond to the **#** column in the table above. Because most rural addresses in the TSE registry have no street number (just "Main Street, no number"), the sites in the municipal seat (markers clustered close together, at the center of the map) are approximate, lightly spread apart just so they don't overlap; the rural-district sites correspond to the identified locality.



Click a number on the map to see the polling location.

Base map: © OpenStreetMap contributors. Coordinates from geocoding (Photon/Komoot) the location and district names in the TSE's registry.

10 · CONCLUSION

WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Reading the results precinct by precinct, and then district by district, shows that the 2024 turnaround closes an arc of **twenty years and six elections**: from the 2004 candidacy to the 2024 win, two decades later. The group's vote share grew in nearly every cycle, with a single dip in 2020, and the 2024 result wasn't concentrated in a few strongholds: it was **spread across nearly the entire electoral territory** of the municipality, from the 42 precincts to the 7 districts, with an average gain of 17.9 percentage points in precincts where the majority flipped between 2020 and 2024. That's consistent with a strategy of territorial reach rather than reinforcing already-favorable bases: the one precinct already won in 2020 (precinct 9) saw a relatively modest additional gain (+13.7 p.p.) compared with precincts that started from a loss, and even the district historically most resistant to the group, Ribeirão do Cristo, went from 8.8% in 2004 to 72.3% in 2024.

The expanded campaign coordination in 2024, including for the first time the council candidacies, coincides with a **second turnaround, now in the Legislature**: the same political base that elected Hugo Luiz to the Council in 2020 with just **3 of 9 seats** (an isolated minority) came to control **5 of 9 seats** in 2024 (a simple majority), with a 22.7% increase in the combined vote for the slate's candidates. That suggests a coattail effect between the majoritarian and proportional races, though this analysis doesn't isolate causality between the two. What the 2028 scenarios do not do is in section 11; the study's limits and the author's position are in section 14.

WHAT THE NUMBERS ALLOW US TO IMAGINE FOR 2028

> **This is not a forecast.** The series has only six elections, no 2028 candidate is known, and municipal politics changes from one cycle to the next. What follows are "what if" scenarios: each one states the assumption it uses. The calculations were done in **R** (`analysis/cenarios_2028.R`), with the same TSE and IBGE data as the rest of the study.

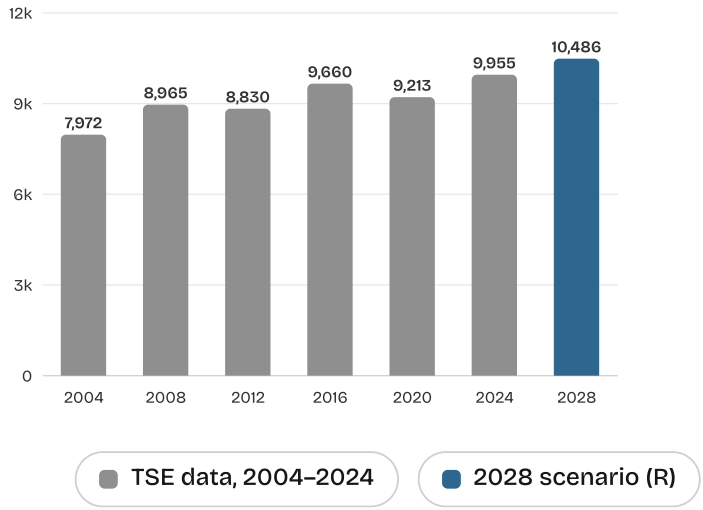
How many votes will be at stake

The electorate grows almost linearly: 9,247 registered voters in 2004 and 12,860 in 2024. Extending that line to 2028 (linear regression with six points), the base scenario is **13,767 registered voters**, with an 80% range of 13,091 to 14,443. With turnout and the share of valid votes between the 2020 and 2024 values (79.1% to 79.7% turnout; 94.7% to 97.1% of those present casting valid votes), that gives about **10,486 valid votes** (9,810 to 11,180), against 9,955 in 2024.

FIGURE 27 Valid votes: historical series and base scenario for 2028

VALID VOTES IN 2028: BASE SCENARIO

valid votes for mayor: data for 2004 to 2024 and the 2028 scenario (in blue)



Extending the 2004 to 2024 growth of the electorate in a straight line, the 2028 base scenario is 13,767 registered voters and 10,486 valid votes (9,810 to 11,180), against 9,955 in 2024. It is a trend assumption, not a forecast.

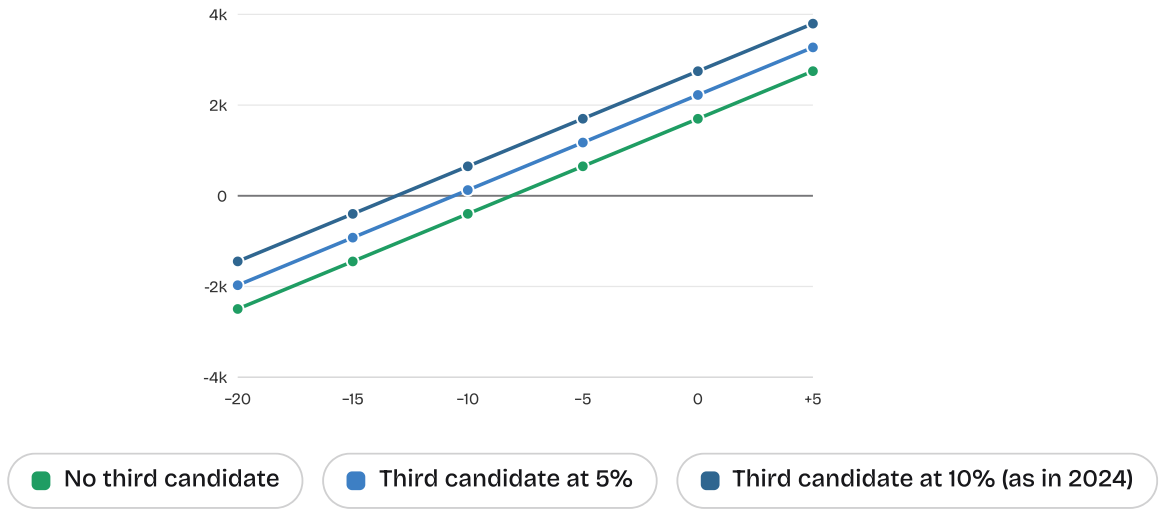
How much the group can lose and still lead

In Alfredo Chaves the candidate with the most votes wins: there is no runoff in a municipality with fewer than 200,000 voters. So the share needed to lead depends on the third candidate. With no third candidate, the group needs more than 50% of valid votes; with a third candidate at 10%, as in 2024, passing 45% is enough. Starting from 2024's 58.1%, the largest drop the group can withstand is **−8.1 p.p.** with no third candidate, **−10.6 p.p.** with a third at 5% and **−13.1 p.p.** with one at 10%.

FIGURE 28 Group's vote margin over the main opposition, by swing scenario

VOTE MARGIN IF PERFORMANCE SWINGS

group votes minus main opposition votes in 2028 (10,486 valid votes), as the group's share rises or falls from 2024's 58.1%, in percentage points



Above the zero line, the group leads. With no third candidate, the group loses the lead between −5 and −10 points; with a third candidate at 10%, as in 2024, it withstands a drop of more than 13 points.

TABLE 11.1 Share needed to lead and largest drop withstood, by third-candidate scenario

HOW MUCH THE GROUP CAN LOSE AND STILL LEAD

starting from 2024's 58.1%, with 10,486 valid votes in 2028 (base scenario)

THIRD CANDIDATE	SHARE NEEDED TO LEAD	VOTES (BASE SCENARIO)	LARGEST SWING WITHSTOOD
No third candidate	50.0%	5,243	−8.1 p.p.
Third candidate at 5%	47.5%	4,981	−10.6 p.p.
Third candidate at 10% (as in 2024)	45.0%	4,719	−13.1 p.p.

Source: calculation in R (`analysis/cenarios_2028.R`) on `resumo_prefeito_2004_2024.csv`. Share needed = (100 − third) / 2, the percentage above which the group beats the main opposition.

As a yardstick, the history itself: between consecutive elections the group's share swung from −8.0 to +18.1 p.p. (mean +6.3; standard deviation 9.8, with only five swings). If the 2028 swing followed that spread around zero, the result would fall between 45.6% and 70.6% in

80% of cases: a range far too wide to call a forecast, and one that includes precisely the 45% to 50% threshold.

And in the districts

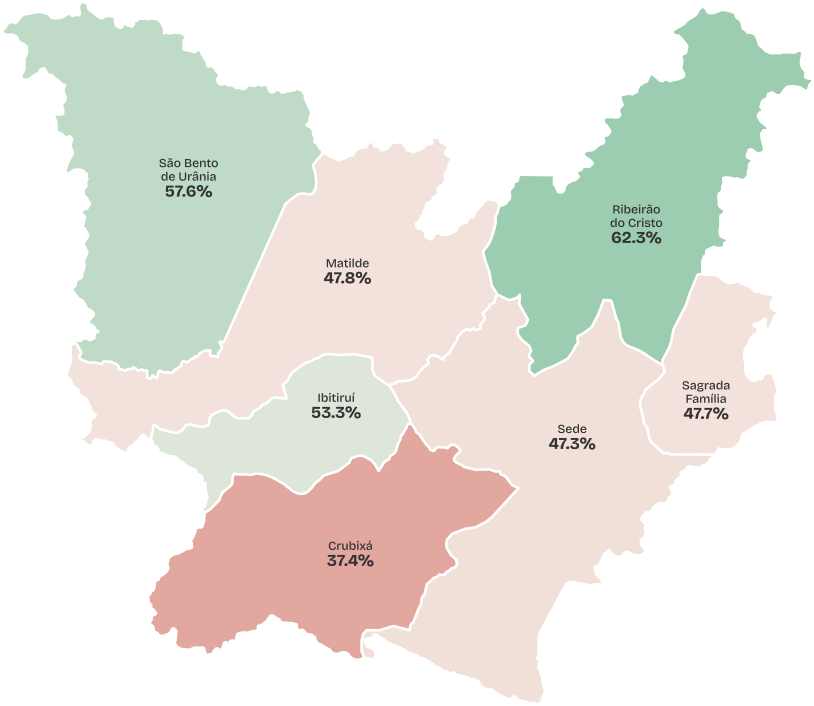
Applying the same swing to every district (an unrealistic assumption, but useful to see where the advantage is most fragile), the group keeps more than 50% in 6 of the seven districts with a 5-point drop and in 3 with a 10-point drop. Sede, which holds about two thirds of valid votes, loses its absolute majority between −5 and −10 p.p.: that is where the lead is decided.

FIGURE 29 Group's share by district under a uniform swing, starting from the 2024 result

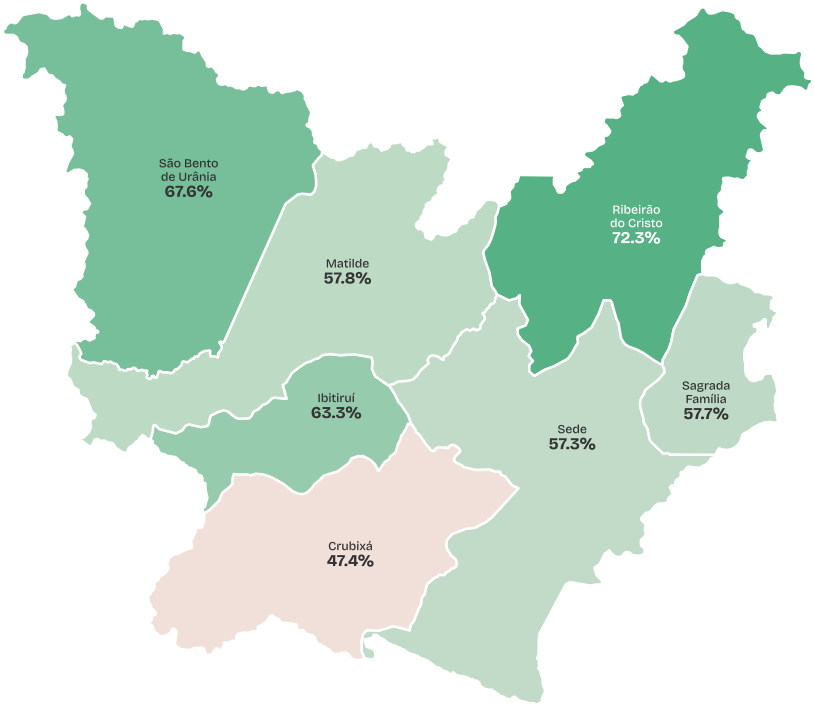
THE DISTRICTS UNDER EACH SCENARIO

the group's share in each district if the 2024 result rises or falls by the same number of points in all of them, choose the swing

−10 p.p.



As in 2024



≤20% · group behind — group ahead · ≥80%

All swings, by district

District	−20 p.p.	−15 p.p.	−10 p.p.	−5 p.p.	As in 2024	+5 p.p.
Sede	37.3%	42.3%	47.3%	52.3%	57.3%	62.3%
Crubixá	27.4%	32.4%	37.4%	42.4%	47.4%	52.4%
Ibitiruí	43.3%	48.3%	53.3%	58.3%	63.3%	68.3%
Matilde	37.8%	42.8%	47.8%	52.8%	57.8%	62.8%
Ribeirão do Cristo	52.3%	57.3%	62.3%	67.3%	72.3%	77.3%
Sagrada Família	37.7%	42.7%	47.7%	52.7%	57.7%	62.7%
São Bento de Urânia	47.6%	52.6%	57.6%	62.6%	67.6%	72.6%

With a −5 point swing in every district, the group keeps more than 50% in 6 of the seven; with −10, in 3. Since Sede holds about two thirds of the valid votes, that is where the lead is decided.

What this exercise does not do

- **It does not know who the candidates will be.** Nor whether the mayor elected in 2024 will run for re-election, nor how many slates there will be.
- **It assumes a uniform swing.** In practice districts swung in very different ways: Ribeirão do Cristo went from 9.4% in 2012 to 58.2% in 2020.
- **It does not model re-election effects, the political climate, or polls.** There are six data points; any more sophisticated model would be false precision.

The code that produces every number in this section:

```
# analysis/cenarios_2028.R (base R, no extra packages)
m_aptos <- lm(aptos ~ ano, data = compar)            # linear trend of the electorate
pred    <- predict(m_aptos, data.frame(ano = 2028),
                   interval = "prediction", level = 0.80)
votos_validos <- aptos * comparecimento * validos_sobre_comp

share_grupo    <- share_2024 + oscilacao             # uniform swing, in p.p.
share_oposicao <- 100 - share_grupo - terceiro       # third candidate: 0, 5 or 10%
margem <- (share_grupo - share_oposicao) / 100 * votos_validos
```

WHY THE SAME PARTY GOVERNED FOR TWENTY YEARS, AND WHY 2024 WAS DIFFERENT

Alfredo Chaves is a small municipality in the interior of Espírito Santo that had the same political administration for 20 years, from 2005 to the end of 2024. The PSB won all five mayoral elections from 2004 to 2020, and the political base analyzed here only won in 2024, taking office in January 2025. This section presents six hypotheses for that trajectory. **They are hypotheses, not results:** the series has only six elections and a single municipality, which rules out statistical tests, and each hypothesis rests on public sources cited in the text or, where stated, on the author's knowledge of the local context. None of them implies a negative judgment about the administration of those who governed the municipality. To compare the elections, the indicator is "votes that did not go to the PSB candidate", as a percentage of valid votes.

Why the same group governed for 20 years (2004 to 2020 elections)

H1. Memory of a previous administration. Ruzerte de Paula Gaigher was mayor for two terms, the second from 2001 to 2004, and also deputy mayor and state deputy. He died on February 19, 2016, aged 60 [Alfredo Chaves City Council; Século Diário, Feb. 22, 2016]. Auditing the 2004 fiscal year, the Espírito Santo Court of Accounts found delays in paying municipal employees' salaries, in contrast with on-time payment of the mayor's, deputy mayor's and treasurer's pay, spending on education and health below the constitutional minimums and a breach of the Fiscal Responsibility Law, and imposed a fine of 3,000 VRTE; the appeal was denied [Rulings TC-166/2009 and TC-740/2014, TCE-ES, Official Gazette of Dec. 15, 2014]. The hypothesis is that part of the electorate feared the return of that kind of administration, even though he was not a candidate. The data are compatible: the 2004 election, at the end of that term, had the largest margin of the series (66.9% to 26.4%), and the margin narrowed afterwards (63.6% to 36.4% in 2012 and 52.0% to 48.0% in 2016). Since he died in 2016, the hypothesis only holds up to that election.

H2. A search for stability during the pandemic. In 2016 the race was close (52.0% to 48.0%). In 2020 the trend reversed: the PSB rose to 56.4% and the main opposition fell to 40.0%. Nationally, mayoral re-election was the lowest of the series in 2016 (49%) and the highest so far in 2020, between 62% and 64% depending on the source [TSE; National Confederation of Municipalities]. This follows the local pattern, but it does not show that the pandemic was the cause.

Why the result changed in 2024

H3. Succession and a new name. Dr. Fernando could not run for a third consecutive term [Federal Constitution, art. 14, § 5]. Roberto Fiorin, the 2012 winner for the PSB, died on February 26, 2019, aged 61 [A Gazeta, Feb. 26, 2019]. The PSB fielded Rolmar Botecchia, a cattle rancher and retired Incaper technician, president of the Alfredo Chaves Dairy Cooperative since 2004 [Portal 27, Nov. 6, 2023]. He joined the PSB on December 18, 2023, at an event with the mayor, and his candidacy was presented as the mayor's succession [Folha Online ES, Dec. 19, 2023]. The PSB candidate got 3,177 votes in 2024, 2,019 fewer than the PSB in 2020, while the group analyzed went from 3,681 to 5,779 votes and the PL candidate got 999.

H4. A wish for alternation after 20 years. The hypothesis is that the electorate wanted alternation to the point of accepting the candidacy of a 25-year-old, Hugo Luiz, which at first seemed unlikely. This is the author's assessment and needs support. The data point to a broad shift: the group won all 42 precincts in 2024, including precincts where it had about 28% in 2020, and turnout stayed stable. Together, the votes for Hugo Luiz and for the PL candidate reached 68.1% of valid votes (6,778 votes), the largest vote against the PSB candidate in the series. In the 2008 to 2024 elections, the votes that did not go to the PSB candidate were 33.1%, 36.4%, 48.0%, 43.6% and 68.1% [TSE]. In 2004 the PSB was not the governing party, so that election is left out of the comparison. Voting for another candidate does not necessarily mean wanting change. Five registered polls show Hugo Luiz leading throughout the campaign. In April, in a two-name scenario, he had 54.8% and Rolmar 21.6% of the sample, with 23.6% undecided, blank or null [Instituto Solução, TRE-ES no. 09808/2024, Aqui Notícias, Apr. 25, 2024]. Among those who chose one of the three candidates, he had 57.4% in August [Veritá, ES-08806/2024], 58.1% in September and 57.0% in October [Inove Consultoria, ES-04825/2024 and ES-06358/2024] and 62.6% in late September [Ipopes], against 58.1% in the election. In all of them, the PSB candidate had the highest rejection among the candidates included, from 21.0% to 38.2% of the sample, against 7.0% to 15.4% for Hugo Luiz. In Veritá (Aug. 29 to 31, 352 interviews, margin of error 5.5 points), 74.7% of respondents said city hall needed to change most things or everything, and 25.2% that it needed to continue most things or everything, even though 42.1% rated the mayor's administration as excellent or good. The polls were commissioned by local portals and companies and should be read with caution. A sixth, from September 17, which gives the lead to Rolmar Botecchia, was excluded because the document shows no institute or registration number and diverges from the others and from the result.

H5. Renewal of the group against continuity of the group. The group analyzed lost in 2016 and 2020 with the same candidate, Ronaldo Bianchi, and in 2024 fielded Hugo Luiz, 25, elected councilman in 2020 and making his first run for mayor. The PSB candidate was also a new name in the race, but he was presented as the mayor's successor, at an event with

him and with party leaders [Folha Online ES, Dec. 19, 2023]. The hypothesis is that voters saw him as the continuity of the same group running the administration, not as renewal, because the name would change but the structure of government could stay as it was. The choice, on this reading, was between renewing the group and keeping the group, and the 2024 vote would have rewarded renewal [author's account, as a participant in the decision; to be supported].

H6. Split in the governing coalition. The PP was in the PSB's winning coalition from 2004 to 2020 [TSE] and, in 2024, joined that of the group analyzed (Republicanos, PP, MDB and the PSDB-Cidadania Federation). The PSB's coalition in 2020 had seven parties (PP, PSL, Podemos, Cidadania, DEM, PSB and PSDB), and the 2024 one brought together PDT, Podemos, PSB and PSD [TSE, 2020 and 2024 candidacies]. Only Podemos and the PSB stayed, and the PP, PSDB and Cidadania moved to the other side. According to the TSE record, the definitive municipal body of the PP in Alfredo Chaves has Hugo Luiz as president, with a term from March 26, 2024 to December 31, 2026 [TSE, SGIP3, public consultation on Nov. 3, 2026]. The TSE party information system keeps the PP municipal body's compositions since October 2016. In all six compositions before Hugo Luiz's, which cover October 2016 to March 2024, the president was the same former councilman of several terms (from 2000 to 2016), elected by the PSDB and later by the PP, in coalitions that supported the government, and who now appears as vice president [TSE, SGIP3, compositions of the PP municipal body; TSE, 2004 and 2008 candidacies; Hub Político]. The system does not record the period before 2016, so the total time in the presidency cannot be checked. According to the author, he handed the presidency to Hugo Luiz because he did not support the PSB candidate [author's account]. Federal deputy Da Vitória, the PP state president, supported the candidacy [Aqui Notícias, Jan. 2025]. The video announcing Hugo Luiz's affiliation to the PP, then a councilman, was published on March 21, 2024, in collaboration with the party's state account [Instagram, post of Mar. 21, 2024; not auditable source], five days before the start of the term of the body he presides. Since only party members sit on party bodies, the affiliation predates March 26, and the post indicates it had already happened by March 21. The exact date should be confirmed on the TSE affiliation certificate. For a councilman to switch parties without losing his seat, affiliation had to occur in the party-switching window of March 7 to April 5, and the final affiliation deadline was April 6 [TSE]. The split of the coalition that supports the government, which produces more than one competitive candidacy, is one of the factors the literature points to for explaining the loss of power of those who govern.

Limits. None of the six hypotheses was tested with individual-level data, and the evidence about what voters thought comes from registered polls commissioned by local outlets, with no independent survey or interviews. The author directed the 2024 campaign, which may tilt the choice of hypotheses, so each one is marked as a hypothesis and depends on a public source.

ALFREDO CHAVES AMONG THE MUNICIPALITIES OF ESPÍRITO SANTO

So far the study has dealt with a single municipality. To see how unusual the case is, and whether factors common to all municipalities help explain alternation, this section compares Alfredo Chaves with the 78 municipalities of Espírito Santo in the same six elections. The unit is the municipal election, which gives 390 cases (five transitions, from 2008 to 2024, for each municipality). Results by candidate come from the TSE, and population, gross domestic product (GDP) and salaried employment come from IBGE (tables 6579, 5938 and 1685). The ideological position of parties follows the survey of political scientists by Bolognesi, Ribeiro and Codato (*Dados*, 2023), on a scale from 0 (left) to 10 (right), applied to each municipality's council votes. Renamed or merged parties were grouped, and party alternation is counted when the elected mayor's party differs from the previous mayor's. The models are logistic regressions with standard errors clustered by municipality and a control for election year.

A rare case

Alfredo Chaves is the only municipality in Espírito Santo where the same party won five consecutive elections, from 2004 to 2020. No other went beyond three: in 16 municipalities the longest streak was one win, in 54 it was two and in seven it was three. Party alternation is the rule. It occurred in 71.8% of municipalities in 2008, 69.2% in 2012, 84.6% in 2016, 85.9% in 2020 and 73.1% in 2024. Among the 161 cases in which the previous mayor ran for re-election, 62 (38.5%) lost. The question the full set of municipalities raises, then, is why the same group stayed for two decades, and the 2024 turnaround is, in that sense, a return to the state pattern.

Hypotheses of the comparison

The data for all municipalities make it possible to turn some of the hypotheses of section 12 into statements the numbers can contradict. They are labeled HC1 to HC6, so they are not confused with H1 to H6. A caveat on method: they were written after an initial exploration of the data, not before collection. The results are therefore exploratory, not tests of pre-registered hypotheses.

TABLE 13.1 Hypotheses of the 78-municipality comparison and preliminary results

HYPOTHESIS	EXPECTED DIRECTION	RESULT
HC1 End of re-election	More party alternation	Not supported (odds ratio 1.6; p = 0.24)
HC2 Fragmentation	More defeats of those in office	Supported (odds ratio 2.7; p = 0.002)
HC3 Local economy	More defeats where the economy is weaker	Partial: GDP per capita supports (0.72; p = 0.037); employment does not (p = 0.66)
HC4 Ideological wave	More party alternation	Not supported (odds ratio 0.9; p = 0.8)
HC5 Progressistas	More Progressistas mayors	Marginal (odds ratio 2.6; p = 0.050)
HC6 State government	More mayors from the governor's party	Not tested (six government periods); the descriptive observation is compatible

Source: prepared with TSE and IBGE data. Logistic models with standard errors clustered by municipality and controls for election year, population and GDP per capita. The HC3 result for employment uses the 2016 to 2024 elections.

Factors associated with the defeat of those in office

Among the 319 cases in which the previous mayor could run, the strongest factor is the fragmentation of the race. Each additional effective candidate multiplies by 2.7 the odds that he loses, and the result holds when the growth of salaried employment is added (odds ratio 2.8, p = 0.003, in the 2016 to 2024 elections). The effective number of candidates is the inverse of the sum of squared vote shares of each candidate in the first round (Laakso and Taagepera, 1979). It is compatible with a split in the governing coalition (H6), but it is also a consequence of it, so the association does not prove that the split causes the defeat. Municipalities with lower GDP per capita had more defeats of those in office, while the effect of population size is not statistically distinguishable from zero. For party alternation, taken across all 390 cases, no factor is statistically significant: the end of re-election (odds ratio 1.6, p = 0.24), fragmentation (1.3, p = 0.20), population, GDP per capita and the change in ideological score do not separate municipalities that changed party from those that did not.

TABLE 13.2 Factors associated with the defeat of the previous mayor who could run (odds ratio)

FACTOR	ODDS RATIO	95% CI	P
Effective number of candidates	2.66	1.43 to 4.93	0.002

FACTOR	ODDS RATIO	95% CI	P
Population (logarithm)	0.79	0.59 to 1.06	0.11
GDP per capita (logarithm)	0.72	0.52 to 0.98	0.037
Change in councilors' ideological score	0.91	0.48 to 1.74	0.78

Source: prepared with TSE and IBGE data. Logistic regression with 319 cases in which the previous mayor could run, standard errors clustered by municipality and control for election year (reference: 2008). The dependent variable equals 1 when the previous mayor was not re-elected.

The right and the Progressistas

The average ideological score of the council vote in the state rose from 6.18 in 2004 to 6.78 in 2024. In Alfredo Chaves it went from 5.77 to 6.90: the municipality was below the state average until 2020 and above it in 2024. In the classification used, the PSB scores 4.05 and the Progressistas 8.20. The number of mayors elected by the Progressistas in the state was 4 in 2004, 3 in 2008, 4 in 2012, 3 in 2016, 6 in 2020 and 12 in 2024, and its share of council votes went from 5.9% to 11.4% over the same period. In the models, the odds that the elected mayor belongs to the Progressistas rise with the change in the councilors' ideological score (odds ratio 2.6; 95% CI: 1.00 to 6.52; p = 0.050). In the August 2024 Veritá poll, among the 279 respondents who answered, 58.7% identified with the right, 25.4% with the center and 15.9% with the left. That is compatible with the reading that part of the party's growth in 2024 follows a shift of the state electorate to the right, not only local factors. The shift, however, does not on its own predict party alternation.

The PSB elected 22 mayors in 2024, the highest number of the series, and lost 8 of the 13 it had held since 2020 (3 to the Progressistas, 2 to Podemos, 2 to the PL and 1 to the MDB), while winning another 17. The governor's party also concentrates mayors in elections held during the governor's term: the MDB had 21 mayors in 2008 and 16 in 2016, and the PSB 21 in 2012 and 22 in 2024. This is an observation compatible with the influence of state government on municipal elections, which the study does not test, since there are only six government periods.

Economy and approval of the government

Economic voting theory predicts that voters keep those who govern well and replace those who govern badly (Downs, 1957). In Alfredo Chaves, the available indicators do not point to poor performance before 2024. Salaried employment grew 25.5% between 2017 and 2021, against 8.6% on average in the state, and the municipality had 0.221 salaried workers per

inhabitant in 2021, against 0.152 on the state average. In the models, employment growth and employment per inhabitant were not associated with the defeat of those in office. The IBGE series ends in 2021 and there is no annual municipal unemployment rate; the Census has that figure only for 2010 and 2022. For 2023, the formal-job balance of the Novo CAGED, from the Ministry of Labor, shows Alfredo Chaves created 112 jobs (7.8 per thousand inhabitants), above the state median (5.5 per thousand) and 25th among the 78 municipalities, with no association with party alternation in 2024 (odds ratio 1.02 per thousand inhabitants, p = 0.69, in 78 cases). Two polls registered with the TSE in 2024 asked about the municipal administration. In the first (ES-08806/2024, Aug. 29 to 31, 352 interviews), 42.1% rated the mayor's administration as excellent or good, 28.9% as fair and 28.9% as bad or very bad. In the second (ES-09808/2024, April, 403 interviews), the figures were 36.0%, 35.5% and 27.8%, and the question referred to the municipal administration without naming the mayor. Commissioned by local outlets, they should be read with caution, but they indicate neutral or positive assessment, not rejection, which makes it less likely that the 2024 change was a punishment for poor performance. This reinforces hypotheses H4, H5 and H6.

Limits of the comparison

The comparison increases the number of cases but does not solve the identification problem. The effective number of candidates is an outcome of the race, not a condition prior to it. The ideological classification comes from a 2018 survey and is applied to parties that later changed names and positions; parties without a score (PAN and PRONA, under 1% of votes) were left out of the average. The GDP used is that of the year before the election, IBGE employment runs to 2021 and is supplemented for 2023 only by the Novo CAGED balance, and municipal unemployment was not measured. Confidence intervals are wide, and the results indicate associations, not causes. What the set allows us to say is more modest: Alfredo Chaves is a rare case of continuity, and the fragmentation of the race is the factor that most closely accompanies the defeat of those in office in Espírito Santo municipalities.

Comparison with the Southeast and Brazil

The same calculation was repeated for all Brazilian municipalities, from 1996 to 2024, with the mayor's party as a proxy for the group, because the TSE does not record political groups. Among 5,374 municipalities with an elected mayor in all eight elections, 156 had five or more consecutive wins by the same party, 45 of them in the Southeast, and only Alfredo Chaves is in Espírito Santo. Considering only 2004 to 2020, there were 41 municipalities in Brazil, 12 in the Southeast and one in the state; of the 12 in the Southeast, 11 lost in 2024, as

Alfredo Chaves did. Five consecutive terms for the same party, therefore, exist outside the state, but are rare: about 0.7% of municipalities with a winner in all five elections from 2004 to 2020, both in Brazil (41 of 5,544) and in the Southeast (12 of 1,661).

TABLE 13.3 Streaks of consecutive mayoral wins by the same party, 1996 to 2024

MINIMUM STREAK	MUNICIPALITIES IN BRAZIL	IN THE SOUTHEAST	IN ESPÍRITO SANTO
5 wins	156	45	1 (Alfredo Chaves)
6 wins	45	13	0
7 wins	5	1	0
8 wins	1	0	0

Source: prepared with TSE data (results by candidate and zone, mayor, 1996 to 2024), 5,374 municipalities with an elected mayor in all eight elections. The group is approximated by the mayor's party. Southeast: ES, MG, RJ and SP.

This result does not prove the case is unique, because the mayor's party does not measure political alignment. In Alfredo Chaves the PSB label was stable, but its set of allies was not: the PP, the PSDB and Cidadania were in the PSB coalition in 2020 and made up the group's coalition in 2024. Of the five parties in the winning coalition, three (60%) came from the defeated coalition. Migration of allies is common: in 49 of 101 municipalities where a party with five consecutive wins lost the mayoralty in 2024, the winning coalition had at least one party from the governing coalition of 2020. But Alfredo Chaves is among the six largest shares (60% or more). Public data do not identify which group lost five consecutive elections in each municipality, and coalitions only approximate that composition, so the claim that the case is unique in this sense cannot be made with TSE data.

Context: gross domestic product and education

Alfredo Chaves' gross domestic product, at December 2023 prices, rose from R$ 154.7 million in 2004 to R$ 565.4 million in 2023, a real increase of 265%. Growth was concentrated in the PSB's first two terms (2004 to 2012), with real declines of 4% from 2012 to 2016 and 7% from 2016 to 2020, before a new rise of 23% by 2023. Municipal GDP is highly sensitive to a few sectors and is revised by IBGE, and the study does not use it as an explanation of government performance.

TABLE 13.4 Gross domestic product of Alfredo Chaves at December 2023 prices

YEAR	GDP (R$ MILLION)	GDP PER INHABITANT (R$)	REAL CHANGE SINCE THE PREVIOUS ELECTION
2004	154.7	10,964	-
2008	275.0	18,959	+78%
2012	519.5	37,092	+89%
2016	496.3	33,022	-4%
2020	460.3	31,448	-7%
2023	565.4	40,863	+23%

Source: IBGE, SIDRA, tables 5938 (GDP), 6579 (estimated population) and 1737 (IPCA inflation index); 2023 population from the 2022 Census. Values deflated by the December-to-December IPCA. Accessed on Nov. 7, 2026.

The municipal school system is a strength of the municipality. The Ideb of the early grades rose from 4.7 in 2005 to 6.7 in 2023, and that of the late grades from 4.3 to 6.0, which placed the system among the state's top three at this stage in 2009, 2011, 2019, 2021 and 2023. In the early grades, the rank fell from 1st in 2011 to 15th and 16th since 2015, although the score stayed above the state average. The Municipal Human Development Index (HDI) exists only for the 1991, 2000 and 2010 Censuses. Alfredo Chaves rose from 0.480 to 0.604 and 0.710, growth similar to Brazil's (0.493, 0.612 and 0.727), with education the component that advanced most (from 0.270 to 0.611), and in 2010 income was the lowest component (0.703). Since only 2010 falls within the study period, the index shows the municipality's level but does not allow attributing the result to a government or explaining the 2024 turnaround.

TABLE 13.5 Ideb of Alfredo Chaves' municipal school system and rank among the state's municipal systems

YEAR	EARLY GRADES	RANK IN ES	LATE GRADES	RANK IN ES
2005	4.7	4th	4.3	6th
2007	5.2	4th	4.8	4th
2009	5.8	5th	5.2	2nd
2011	7.0	1st	5.4	1st
2013	6.1	5th	5.0	6th
2015	6.1	15th	4.9	7th

YEAR	EARLY GRADES	RANK IN ES	LATE GRADES	RANK IN ES
2017	6.2	15th	5.4	7th
2019	6.5	15th	6.0	2nd
2021	6.2	16th	5.9	1st
2023	6.7	16th	6.0	3rd

Source: Inep, Ideb results by municipality (2023 edition), municipal network. On IBGE's Cidades@ page, the 2025 Ideb is 7.0 in the early grades and 6.3 in the late grades (1st in the state at this stage). Accessed on Nov. 7, 2026.

TABLE 13.6 Municipal Human Development Index of Alfredo Chaves and Brazil, 1991 to 2010

INDEX	1991	2000	2010	CHANGE 1991 TO 2000	CHANGE 2000 TO 2010
HDI, Alfredo Chaves	0.480	0.604	0.710	+25.8%	+17.5%
HDI, Brazil	0.493	0.612	0.727	+24.1%	+18.8%
Income, Alfredo Chaves	0.570	0.624	0.703	+9.5%	+12.7%
Longevity, Alfredo Chaves	0.718	0.772	0.832	+7.5%	+7.8%
Education, Alfredo Chaves	0.270	0.457	0.611	+69.3%	+33.7%

Source: UNDP, Ipea and FJP, Atlas of Human Development in Brazil (2022). The index is calculated only for Census years, and the 2022 Census value has not been released. Accessed on Nov. 7, 2026.

14 · LIMITATIONS AND BIAS

WHAT THIS STUDY CANNOT SHOW

The study describes what public data shows. There are things the data does not show, and readers should know which ones before drawing conclusions.

What the data does not allow us to conclude

- **Description, not cause.** The numbers show where and when the vote changed, not why. The mayoral turnaround, the growth of the council slate and the wider campaign coordination coincide in time, but nothing here isolates the effect of one on another, nor separates the campaign from the political climate, rival candidates or local factors.
- **Precincts and districts, not voters.** Votes are counted by precinct and summed by district; no data says how each person voted. The correlations between the vote for mayor and for council (section 05) describe precincts and should not be read as individual behavior. This is the ecological inference problem.
- **One municipality, limited comparison.** The detailed series is from Alfredo Chaves. Section 13 compares the case with the state's 78 municipalities and, by the mayor's party, with the Southeast and Brazil, but only with municipality-level results, and it does not identify causes. The hypotheses of section 12 remain without a direct test.
- **Group measured by party and coalition.** The TSE does not record political groups, so the national comparison uses the mayor's party and the composition of coalitions. This approximates political alignment but does not measure it: parties switch sides from one election to the next, as the PP, the PSDB and Cidadania did between 2020 and 2024. The test does not prove the case is unique in Brazil.
- **Economic and social context, not explanation.** GDP, Ideb and the Municipal Human Development Index (section 13) place the municipality, but the HDI exists only for 1991, 2000 and 2010, municipal GDP is highly sensitive to a few sectors, and none of them is tested as a cause of alternation.
- **Districts assigned by polling place.** Each precinct's district comes from its 2024 polling place (section 04). Because precincts in this municipality only receive new numbers and none is renumbered, the assignment holds for every year, but it is still an assignment, not a TSE field.
- **Uneven coverage across years.** Table 3.1 shows what exists for each election. Where a dataset does not cover a year, the analysis is left out rather than estimated.
- **Short series.** There are six elections. That is why the 2028 scenarios (section 11) are stated assumptions, not forecasts.
- **Two sources that cannot be audited in the same way.** The candidacy's Instagram posts (section 07) were read from screenshots, and the TSE registers the 2024 polls without publishing their results (section 08).

The author's position

I was the 2024 campaign director, the child of a 2004 candidate and the brother of the candidate elected in 2024. That can tilt what I chose to analyze and how I framed the result. To reduce the risk, I used only public, reproducible data, with no internal campaign spreadsheets or records; I left the code in the repository so anyone can redo the calculations from the same extracts; I kept in the study the results that are unfavorable to the group (the five consecutive defeats from 2004 to 2020); and I used neutral language, "group" and "opposition". This does not remove the bias. It only makes it checkable.

15 · WHAT THIS STUDY DEMONSTRATES

SKILLS, ONE BY ONE, AND WHERE THEY SHOW UP

This table ties each skill to a verifiable part of the study and the repository. Everything here can be checked in the code or the data.

SKILL	WHAT WAS DONE	WHERE TO LOOK
SQL	A SQLite database with all six elections (5 tables and 2 views) and five queries using CTEs, window functions and joins, automatically checked against the pandas pipeline.	Section 03; `sql/` folder and `scripts/sql_estudo.py`
Pipeline and data quality	Ingestion of TSE and IBGE extracts whose format changes between 2004 and 2024, explicit cleaning rules and declared coverage. The cross-check between SQL and pandas caught and fixed a denominator error in the per-precinct percentages (blank and null ballots inside the total).	Sections 02 and 03; Table 3.1
Visualization	Interactive charts in TypeScript, React and Recharts, a district map with IBGE polygons, alternative text on the charts, mobile reading and a PDF generated from the page itself.	Sections 04 to 11
Statistics	Percentage-point changes by precinct and district, coherence between the mayoral and council vote in each precinct, sensitivity scenarios for 2028 in R with declared assumptions, and explicit limits of inference.	Sections 05, 11, 13 and 14
Data storytelling	A twenty-year arc (five defeats, the turnaround, the territory, the financing, the scenarios), numbered figures whose captions state the conclusion, versions in Portuguese and English, and a declared conflict of interest.	Sections 00 to 15

SKILL	WHAT WAS DONE	WHERE TO LOOK
Reproducibility	Every number links to a public TSE or IBGE extract, the run steps are in the repository, and results unfavorable to the group were kept.	Sections 02 and 14; the repository README

Official data: TSE Open Data Portal, extracts `votacao_secao` and `votacao_candidato_munzona`, six municipal elections from 2004 to 2024, filtered to Alfredo Chaves, Espírito Santo, Brazil. Processing pipeline in Python (pandas) and SQL (SQLite); visualizations in Matplotlib. No electoral figure was estimated or projected: only data publicly auditable in the TSE's repository. The scenarios in section 11 are assumptions, not data.